MINOR SCIENCE

NOMADOLOGY REFERENCE

Reference sheets for *A Thousand Plateaus*, plateaus 12 and 13

"1227: Treatise on Nomadology—The War Machine" and "7000 B.C.: Apparatus of Capture"

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How to use this packet

These are working references for the two plateaus in which Deleuze and Guattari set out nomadology. They were made while writing a response to John Protevi's *Regimes of Violence: Toward a Political Anthropology* (Minnesota, 2025). Each sheet stands on its own, and each has a web version at the address on the cover, often with more detail.

The sheets run in the order of the web index. The name comes first, then the two plateaus entry by entry, then four sheets of concepts, and last two sheets of sources.

READING A SHEET

- Page numbers without a prefix refer to Brian Massumi's translation (Minnesota, 1987). *Mille plateaux* (Minuit, 1980) is cited where the French wording counts, and RoV marks Protevi's book.
- Bold type marks the two terms of a contrast.
- Dashed cells are proposed extensions, not claims made in *A Thousand Plateaus*.
- Markers such as R1 point to findings from the record, spelled out on the sheet's notes page.

HOW THE SHEETS CONNECT

The five machinic processes (III) and the two sciences (IV) are companions, the first for the plateaus' social formations and the second for their kinds of knowledge. The State's three forms (V) takes one proposition of capture in detail. After 1980 (VII) tests the plateaus' claims against later research, while the concordance (VI) and the bibliography (VIII) follow the concepts and the works cited back to their sources.

PRINTING

This version has no blank pages, for reading on screen. For double-sided printing, use the print version, nomadology_reference_packet_print.pdf at the address on the cover, in which each sheet begins on a right-hand page.

Contents

I **Where the name nomadology came from, and what else it could be called** 3
How Deleuze and Guattari built the word, from the Greek root *nem-* and Leibniz's *Monadology*, with names already in use and new ones to weigh

II **Plateaus 12 and 13, entry by entry** 7
Every axiom, proposition and problem of the two plateaus by page. The web version can be searched and shows the quotations

III **The five machinic processes** 10
Warding off, the war machine, capture, polarization and encompassment in coexistence (430-37), with Protevi's marronage on the web

IV **Royal science and nomad science** 13
The two sciences and their shifting borderline (361-74). On the back, questions the partner fields ask from the side of the State, turned into questions for a nomadology

V **The State's three forms** 16
From the archaic imperial State to the modern nation-States, question by question (459)

VI **Nomadology concepts: where they came from and how they were taken up** 18
Each concept in plain words, with the field it began in, where it was worked out before 1980, and how it has been taken up since

VII **After 1980: what later research says about nomadology** 20
Claim by claim, the research since the plateaus that bears them out, complicates them or disputes them

VIII **Nomadology bibliography** 25
The works cited in the notes to the two plateaus (552-71), by field, with what each contributed

Where the name came from

As its spelling suggests, Deleuze and Guattari built the word from two parts. The first, "nomad-," reaches back through Laroche's philology to the Greek root *nem-*, and through Deleuze's own work to the nomad as a figure of thought, to which the steppe historians then gave peoples. The second, "-ology," comes from Leibniz's *Monadology*, though Deleuze and Guattari also set it against "a history," which is to say against the sedentary point of view from which history is written. Each row gives a source they used and what it gives the name.

In brief. The word was not in the 1977 list of names for the project (*Dialogues* 125), and Deleuze never said it in the 1979-80 seminar on capture and war machines. It arrived with the book in 1980, in four places at once: as something lacking, "the opposite of a history" 23, as one of Professor Challenger's aliases 43, as the title of plateau 12, and in the note where a monadology of opened units "should be superseded by a 'nomadology'" 574 n. 27. Its parts, however, are older: "nomad" goes back through Deleuze's 1972 talk and his 1968 "nomadic distribution" to Laroche's Greek. The form of the word comes from Leibniz. We have found no earlier use of "nomadology."

When	Where	What it says	What it brings to the name
A The word arrives, 1977 to 1980			
1977	*Dialogues* 125	In 1977 the project's names were "schizoanalysis, micro-politics, pragmatics, diagrammatism, rhizomatics, cartography"	Nomadology was not yet on the list, which by 1980 had gained one name and lost two
1979-80	Deleuze's seminar on apparatuses of capture and war machines (French and English transcripts)	Session after session, the seminar works through the nomads and the war machine at length	Deleuze never uses the word in these sessions, so it arrived with the book and not in the classroom
1980	*A Thousand Plateaus*, plateaus 1, 3 and 12 23, 43, 351	"What is lacking is a Nomadology, the opposite of a history" (23). Professor Challenger, the scientist borrowed from Conan Doyle, calls his discipline by seven names: "rhizomatics, stratoanalysis, schizoanalysis, nomadology, micropolitics, pragmatics, the science of multiplicities" (43). And it is the title, "Treatise on Nomadology" (351)	In its first uses the word names a lack, an alias and a treatise, all in the same book
B "Nomad-": the Greek root *nem-*			
1949	Emmanuel Laroche, *Histoire de la racine nem- en grec ancien* 115-21, cited in DR and ATP	In Homer, *nomós* is the pasture, "un espace illimité" ("an unlimited space"). The sense of law, *nómos*, came later. *Nomádes* is "an adjective" that names "a way of life, not a nation" 121	Named from a way of grazing across open land, the nomad comes before any people or law
1968	*Difference and Repetition* 36-37 and n. 6	A "nomadic distribution," a nomos "without property, enclosure or measure," taken from Laroche	Deleuze first joins *nomos* and *nomad* here, twelve years before the word. What he means can only be *nomós*, the pasture (Zartaloudis 141)
1969	*The Logic of Sense* 102, 107, 263	Singularities with "a mobile, immanent principle of auto-unification through a nomadic distribution" (102), Nietzsche's "nomadic singularities" (107), and "the world of nomadic distributions and crowned anarchies" (263)	The 1968 phrase recurs through the book, and "nomadic" comes to describe singularities, not peoples
1980	Plateau 12 380 and n. 51	"The nomos came to designate the law, but that was originally because it was distribution," "without division into shares, in a space without borders or enclosure"	Inside the chapter that bears the word, the treatise repeats the philology
C "Nomad-": the nomad as a figure			
1972	Deleuze, "Nomad Thought" 146-49	In this talk on Nietzsche, philosophy "is born out of the imperial state," and the nomad "is not necessarily one who moves"	Eight years before the word, the nomad becomes a figure of thought against the State. Dosse names Nietzsche "a major source of inspiration" for it (*Intersecting Lives* 135)

Bare page numbers refer to the Minnesota translation of *A Thousand Plateaus* (1987). Laroche is *Histoire de la racine nem- en grec ancien* (Klincksieck, 1949), translations the project's own. Toynbee is cited from the Somervell abridgment of vols. I-VI (1947), *Dialogues from the revised edition (2007), Negotiations from the Columbia translation (1995), What Is Philosophy? from the Columbia translation (1994). "Nomad Thought" is cited from The New Nietzsche, ed. Allison (1977). Foucault is cited from Language, Counter-Memory, Practice (1977). Dosse is Gilles Deleuze and Félix Guattari: Intersecting Lives (Columbia, 2010). Source: work/name_research_nov04.md.*

Where the name came from, continued

When	Where	What it says	What it brings to the name
D "Nomad-": the studies of nomads in the notes History is written "from the sedentary point of view … even when the topic is nomads" 23			
1377	Ibn Khaldun, *Muqaddimah* (ATP 366, 481, 555 n. 31, 557 n. 51)	Bedouinism, "the bedouin life-style, not the ethnic group," set against city living, and a nomad war machine defined by "families or lineages PLUS esprit de corps" (366, 555 n. 31). For Ibn Khaldun, "Bedouins are prior to sedentary people"	Of the studies in the notes, this is the oldest and the nearest to a nomadology. The plateaus keep his pair and reverse its order: "it is the town that invents agriculture" (481)
1934	Toynbee, *A Study of History* (Somervell 168-69; ATP 381, 482)	Farmers who emigrate "changed their habitat in order not to change their habits," while the others "flung themselves upon the Steppe … to make themselves at home on it." Nomadism is "a society without a history" (169)	"Toynbee is profoundly right" that the nomad "does not move" (381). The plateaus keep his nomad and drop his verdict that nomadism is an arrested civilization
1934 and 1939	Vladimirtsov, *Le régime social des Mongols* (French 1948), and Grousset, *L'Empire des steppes* (ATP 394, 560 nn. 71, 73, 574 n. 30, 575 n. 37)	Here are the Soviet and the bourgeois histories of the steppe. Vladimirtsov gives the nomads a "feudal interpretation" (560 n. 73), and Grousset traces the art of the steppes and its "slowness"	Both belong to the historians who "consider the nomads a pitiable segment of humanity that understands nothing" (394), and the plateaus draw on them anyway
1948	Pierre Hubac, *Les nomades* (ATP 382, 557 n. 53)	Nomadism is explained less by universal changes of climate than by the "divagation of local climates"	Hubac wrote a whole book on nomads, which the plateaus credit before they correct it, since he "tends to confuse nomads and migrants" (557 n. 53)
1954 to 1978	Emperaire, Thesiger, Carpenter and Milovanoff on nomad space (ATP 382, 557 nn. 49, 54-56)	Emperaire's "nomads of the sea" take an itinerary "from campsite to campsite." Thesiger's sand desert and Carpenter's ice desert show "a whole minor science of qualitative variables and traces." Among Milovanoff's Larbaa nomads, "the dwelling is tied not to a territory but rather to an itinerary"	From these comes the nomad of smooth space, a way of dwelling and of finding one's way, so that the word keeps its nomads without naming a people
1969	Mikhail Griaznov, *The Ancient Civilization of Southern Siberia* (ATP 430, 565 n. 13)	"it was the sedentary farmers who went out on the steppe and became nomadic, during the Bronze Age"	Nomadism becomes "a movement, a becoming that affects sedentaries" (430), and so the nomad follows the town
1979	Kenneth White, *Intellectual Nomadism*, unpublished (ATP 379 and n. 47)	A "properly nomad thought" drawn from the marriage of "the Celt and the Orient"	Alone in the notes, White offers a nomadology of thought, which the plateaus take up with a warning that the theme of a race can turn "into a racism"
E "-ology": monadology, and the opposite of a history			
1714	Leibniz, *Monadology*, as Deleuze taught it in April 1980	This is the title on which the word is built. In the course, monads are closed "because there is no exterior"	*Nomad* is an anagram of *monad*, and *nomadology* of *monadology*
1969	*The Logic of Sense* 113-14	In "the theater of Leibniz" there is "a 'vague Adam,' that is, a vagabond, a nomad, an Adam = x common to several worlds"	The first passage to set the nomad beside Leibniz, eleven years before the word. The route runs from "vague" to "vagabond," as at ATP 367
1980	Plateau 14 574 n. 27, after Gilles Châtelet, "Sur une petite phrase de Riemann" (1979)	Once monads are "no longer thought to be closed upon themselves" and enter "step-by-step local relations," "the purely monadological point of view proves inadequate and should be superseded by a 'nomadology'"	It is the only passage that makes the word out of another word, so that nomadology is monadology with its units opened
1977 and 1980	*Dialogues* 31, plateau 1 23	"Nomads have no history, they only have geography" (*Dialogues* 31). "What is lacking is a Nomadology, the opposite of a history" (23)	The "-ology" names a kind of account set against history, not a science of nomads
	François Dosse, *Intersecting Lives* 257	Dosse reads the title "Treatise on Nomadology" as "a serious and yet ironic reference" to Spinoza's *Theological-Political Treatise*	This is Dosse's reading of the word "Treatise," which Deleuze and Guattari never state
F After 1980			
1986	Semiotext(e)	*Nomadology: The War Machine*, plateau 12 printed alone in English	With this booklet the word became the English name for the treatise, cut off from plateau 13 and from the monadology note
1987	Kenneth White, *L'Esprit nomade* 46-53	A section titled "Nomadologie française" gathers a French current, 1966 to 1984, that drew on the same steppe books as ATP	White applies the label backward, to a current that includes ATP, and we have found no use of the word before 1980
1988	*The Fold* 137, *Negotiations* 152-53	Monads "kept half open as if by a pair of pliers" "overtake monadology with a 'nomadology'" (*Fold* 137). Interviewers quote the word back, "you set out a 'nomadology'" (*Negotiations* 152)	Deleuze uses the word again for the opened monad, with no steppe in it
1991	*What Is Philosophy?* 95-96	"Philosophy is a geophilosophy in precisely the same way that history is a geohistory from Braudel's point of view" (95)	Deleuze and Guattari's later name for the claim against history

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Approaches that come close

Several approaches outside Deleuze and Guattari's orbit come close to nomadology. Instead of grading them, the sheet ends each row on the question that would turn its concept toward a nomadology. The "Part" column says which part of the name each approach touches, with "-ology" standing for the claim against history. The numbers point to the guiding problems on the back of the sheet on royal and nomad science.

Concept	Works	Where it comes close	Part	Problem	The question it opens
Pastoral power	Foucault, *Security, Territory, Population* (1977-78 lectures), with Toynbee, *A Study of History* (1934)	A power exercised "not over a territory" but over "the flock in its movement" (125, cited in Zartaloudis 139), caring for each one and for all together. Toynbee sees it from the nomad's side, conquerors who become "shepherds of men" over subjects whose name means "flock" (Somervell 172, 182). Like nomadology, it starts from a multiplicity on the move	nomos	3, 6	*When a power tends a flock on the move, each one and all together, is the flock composed by its own movement or by the shepherd's count?*
Nomos as use	Zartaloudis, *The Birth of Nomos* (2019)	Nomos as a field of coexisting uses that jurists later projected back as law. A nomos, following Hirzel, is "a power that is; not a power that is 'had'" (xxxvii)	nomos	1	*If nomos was first a way of life, what had to be converted before it could be presented as a law that was always there?*
Nomos as appropriation	Schmitt, *The Nomos of the Earth* (1950)	The same word, and the question of how the earth is ordered, with taking first, dividing second and pasture last	nomos	1, 7	*When an order dates itself from an act of taking, what does it make of the life that came before it?*
Legibility	Scott, *Seeing Like a State* (1998), *The Art of Not Being Governed* (2009)	Counting as the way a State makes a population legible, against local measures, and peoples who live beyond the reach of the count	-ology	3	*When flight is told as an escape from the State's count, how does the fleeing body count itself?*
Silences	Trouillot, *Silencing the Past* (1995)	Power enters the record at every stage, from the making of sources to the making of narratives	-ology	1	*When an archive is made by the power it records, what does that power present as its own invention?*
Linkages	Wolf, *Europe and the People without History* (1982)	"Wide-ranging linkages among populations" before European expansion (25), against a world of bounded societies spinning off each other like "billiard balls" (6)	nomad	4	*What moves between formations without belonging to any one of them?*
Seasonal variation	Graeber and Wengrow, *The Dawn of Everything* (2021)	Societies that changed their social form with the seasons, taking on a hierarchy for part of the year and setting it down again	nomad	2	*When a society takes on a hierarchy for one season, what keeps the season from becoming a change in kind?*
Dependence on the outside	Khazanov, *Nomads and the Outside World* (1983), Lindner, "What Was a Nomadic Tribe?" (1982)	No pastoral economy is self-sufficient. Lindner finds the tribe was "a political organism open to all who were willing to subordinate themselves to its chief" (701)	nomad	4, 5	*If no pastoral formation can live on its own, how does it stay open to the sedentary world without being divided by it?*

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Other names

Below are the names already in use and what a new name would need. Each route then ends on a suggested name. Apart from geophilosophy, which is Deleuze and Guattari's own, we have found none of them in use as a name.

Names already in use

Challenger's seven names. Rhizomatics, stratoanalysis, schizoanalysis, nomadology, micropolitics, pragmatics, the science of multiplicities 43

Geophilosophy. Deleuze and Guattari's own later name, for a philosophy that arises from "a geography rather than a historiography" (What Is Philosophy? 96). They credit Nietzsche with founding it (102)

The 1977 aliases. Schizoanalysis, micro-politics, pragmatics, diagrammatism, rhizomatics, cartography (Dialogues 125). Nomadology joined the series in 1980, and diagrammatism and cartography left it

Geopoetics. The name Kenneth White has used since the late 1970s for "cette densification de la géographie" ("this densification of geography") that the nomad must invent (L'Esprit nomade 11, 272-94). A rival name in use, with the nomad kept outside politics

Minor science, nomad science. The science that follows its material, against royal science 361-74. It is the name of this site

Nomad thought. The title of Deleuze's 1972 talk, and of the thought set against the State form 376-80

Mobile pastoralism. What steppe research now calls the way of life once named nomadism (Humphrey and Sneath). It names an economy, not a method

What a new name would need

1. It should not name a people. In Greek the word named a way of life, "not a nation" (Laroche 121)
2. It should keep the sense of distribution without division into shares, which plateau 12 takes from the Greek nomos 380
3. It should keep the opened monad of the Riemann note, in which each unit has direct relations with its neighbors 574 n. 27
4. It should put politics before being, as Guattari did first ("before Being there is politics," Dialogues 17) and A Thousand Plateaus repeats 203
5. If it ends in "-logy," it should say why, given the observation below
6. It should make sense to readers outside philosophy

Where one could come from

From nem-. A name for distribution without division into shares 380. **Suggested: Nemology.** The root nem- with "-logy." It also stays clear of "nomology," which already means the science of laws

From the nomad as a figure. A name for a way of life without a people, like Laroche's adjective nomádes 121, or for nomad thought ("Nomad Thought," 1972). **Suggested: Nomad thought.** The title of Deleuze's 1972 talk, already set against the State form. Unlike Braidotti's "nomadic subjects," it names a thought and not a self

From the monad. A name for the monad once it is opened and joined to its neighbors 574 n. 27. **Suggested: Open monadology.** Leibniz's word kept, minus the closure the Riemann note removes

From the opposite of a history. A name for geography against history 23. **Suggested: Geophilosophy.** Deleuze and Guattari's own name from 1991, already in use (What Is Philosophy? 95-96)

From minor science. A name for the science that follows its material 361-74. **Suggested: Ambulant science, or vagabond science.** Both are Deleuze and Guattari's own words, though neither has been a title: "the ambulant sciences" (372-74), and Husserl's "vague, in other words, vagabond or nomadic" essences (367). The Logic of Sense gives the same adjective to Leibniz's "vague Adam, that is, a vagabond, a nomad" (113-14)

From the path. A name for following place after place, in a space "explored only by legwork" 371. **Suggested: Periegetics.** From the Greek periēgēsis, "a leading around," the genre of Pausanias's tour of Greece, which describes each place as it comes. Kenneth White calls a wandering, anarchist method "une périegèse" ("a periegesis," L'Esprit nomade 58). It has no people in it and no "-logy"

From the word itself. Keep "nomadology" and tell its history, or add to Challenger's seven names 43, as the joke invites. **Suggested: Nemesiology, a name of our own, offered as an eighth for Challenger's list.** From the same root comes nemesis, the anger of the gods at anyone who takes more than a share, and Laroche puts it in his title as one of the root's four words. Such a name would keep the punishment in view, which is to say the very thing a distribution without shares escapes

Our own observation, which Deleuze and Guattari do not make, is that "nomado-logy" puts a logos over the nomos. Plateau 12 calls this move "the triumph of the logos or the law over the nomos" 373.

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Plateaus 12 and 13, entry by entry

An index to the two plateaus on nomadology and the State: every axiom, proposition, and problem, and under each, every claim, contrast, list, definition, and question, by page. The quotations behind each line are in the web version and in *work/atp_12_13_inventory.md*. « Elsewhere » under each heading names the seminars and sources where the idea is worked out; the passages are in the web version and *work/context/context_12_13.md*.

Axiom I · 351

The war machine is exterior to the State apparatus.
Elsewhere: Seminar 79-80 s.1, Dialogues, Guattari seminar

Proposition I · 351

This exteriority is first attested to in mythology, epic, drama, and games.
Elsewhere: Seminar 79-80 s.1, Seminar 79-80 s.2, Dialogues, Dumézil, Guattari seminar, Seminar 1977

351 Two heads of sovereignty (Dumézil)
351 Their oppositions, term by term
352 The State's procedure
352 Two ways the State does without war
352 Indra against the two heads
352 Becoming against binary distribution
352 The thesis of Proposition I
352-53 Chess and Go
353 Go's four operations on territory
353 "Another justice, another movement, another space-time."
353 The flash between two States (de Heusch, the Bantu myth)
354 The war machine seen from the State: six negatives
354 The warrior's three sins (Dumézil)
354 "He didn't understand."
354 The problem of conceptualizing exteriority
354 The danger of confusion
354 The muddle
354-55 Between the two heads
355 The State has none of its own
355 Clausewitz first named
355 The man of war outmoded
355 The Amazons (Kleist's *Penthesilea*)
356 The alternative of the defeated war machine
356 Kleist's three elements
356 Kleist's rhythm
356 The question of the conquered war machine

Problem I · 356

Is there a way of warding off the formation of a State apparatus (or its equivalents in a group)?
Elsewhere: Seminar 79-80 s.1, Dialogues, Seminar 1977

Proposition II · 357

The exteriority of the war machine is also attested to by ethnology (a tribute to the memory of Pierre Clastres).
Elsewhere: Seminar 79-80 s.1, Seminar 79-80 s.3, Clastres, Dialogues

357 The evolutionist postulate
357 Definition of the State
357 Two kinds of mechanism
357 The chief
357 War against the State
357 Hobbes reversed
357-58 War and exchange
358 Collective mechanisms of inhibition
358 Meunier's three mechanisms (the Bogotá street gangs)
358 Animal packs
358 High society and gangs
358 Rhizome against arborescence
358 Discipline is the State's
358-59 What D&G keep from Clastres
359 "We do not see how the State can be explained by what it presupposes, even with recourse to dialectics."
359 War against actual and potential States
359 Barbaric and savage
359 Not conquest
359 Voluntary servitude (La Boétie)
359 Where Clastres fails
359 The old scenario
360 The Urstaat
360 The inverse hypothesis, "of greater importance."
360 The law of the State
360 No universal State, and the outside is not foreign policy
360 The two directions of the outside
360 The two directions merge
360 The form of exteriority
360 Identity against metamorphosis
360-61 Coexistence, not independence

Proposition III · 361

The exteriority of the war machine is also attested to by epistemology, which intimates the existence and perpetuation of a 'nomad' or 'minor science.'
Elsewhere: Seminar 79-80 s.1, Seminar 79-80 s.2, Seminar 79-80 s.9, Dialogues, Dumézil, Querrien, Recherches 13, Seminar 1977, Seminar 27.2.79, deleuze_boulez_proust_time.txt

361 Neither technology nor royal science
361-62 The four characteristics of "this kind of eccentric science."
362 The figure as event
362 Theorem and problem
362 The problem is not an obstacle (against Gabriel Marcel)
362 What royal science does to the problem
362 Problemata
362 Two modes of formalization
362 What State science keeps
362 Nomad science is "barred."
362 The savants' position
362-63 Four borderline phenomena
363 Two hydraulics
363 The list of savants
363 The sea and the fleet in being (Virilio)
363-64 Rhythm and measure
364 The tension-limit
364 Form-matter against material-forces
364 Two supports of Gothic stone cutting
364 Operative geometry
364 "One does not represent, one engenders and traverses."
364-65 Equations differently placed
365 Desargues
365 What royal science tolerates
365 Church and State against the guilds
365-66 Bridges
366 "What is a collective body?"
366 The lobby
366 Body against organism, spirit against soul
366 Ibn Khaldun's formula
366 Fringes of every collective body
367 Husserl's protogeometry
367 Circle and roundness
367 Thinghood and corporeality
367 Two conceptions, one field
367 Husserl and Kant as men of the State
367 Science and technology
367 "The State is perpetually producing and reproducing ideal circles, but a war machine is necessary to make something round."
368 Nomad science and work
368 The State's affair with labor
368 Journeymen's power
368 The State's reply
368 Two planes
368 Dequalification
368 The intellectuals
368 Why the State represses nomad science
368-69 The thesis on science and the social field
369 The hylomorphic model
369 Nomad science's schema
369 Support and ornament
369 Compars and dispars
369 Nomad equations
369-70 Logos and nomos
370 Gravity as the form of royal science
370 Metric multiplicities
370 Supplement, not refutation
371 Smooth space as the space of the smallest deviation
371 Nonmetric multiplicities
371 Celeritas and Gravitas, qualitative
371 The role of the opposition
372 Serres's formula
372 Reproducing and following
372 The royal ideal
372 When one must follow
372 Two meanings of Earth
372 Definition of the ambulant sciences
373 Translation into a compars
373 The current that escapes
373 Not more irrational
373 No autonomy
373 Royal science's power
374 Safety
374 The "more."
374 Metric power
374 The division of labor between the sciences

Problem II · 374

Is there a way to extricate thought from the State model?
Elsewhere: Seminar 79-80 s.1, Seminar 79-80 s.9, Dialogues, Difference and Repetition

Proposition IV · 374

The exteriority of the war machine is attested to, finally, by noology.
Elsewhere: Seminar 79-80 s.1, Seminar 79-80 s.9, Dialogues, Difference and Repetition

374 Form before content
374-75 The image of thought's two heads
375 The event between
375 Not a metaphor
375 The exchange
375 Rebel and consenting subjects
375 "The State gives thought a form of interiority, and thought gives that interiority a form of universality."
376 The legislator and the subject
376 Philosophy as ground
376 Common sense
376 The image trainers
376 Definition of noology
376 Laughable gravity
376 Counterthoughts
376-77 Two faults of "private thinker."
377 Aphorism and maxim
377 "Every thought is already a tribe, the opposite of a State."
377 No symmetry
377 Method and smooth space
377 "Thought is like the Vampire; it has no image."
377 Relay, not monument
377-78 Two pathetic texts
378 Being a foreigner in one's own tongue
378 Four contrasts of thought
378 The man of the State behind the archer
378 The worst danger
379 Two universals
379 Nomad thought
379 The dangers
379 The criteria
379-80 Construction, not rediscovery
380 "All of thought is a becoming, a double becoming, rather than the attribute of a Subject and the representation of a Whole."

Axiom II · 380

The war machine is the invention of the nomads (insofar as it is exterior to the State apparatus and distinct from the military institution). As such, the war machine has three aspects, a spatiogeographic aspect, an arithmetic or algebraic aspect, and an affective aspect.
Elsewhere: Seminar 79-80 s.1, Seminar 79-80 s.13, 15a-GD-Leibniz28April1987-English-Revision-2024.txt, Difference and Repetition

Proposition V · 380

Nomad existence necessarily effectuates the conditions of the war machine in space.
Elsewhere: Seminar 79-80 s.1, Seminar 79-80 s.13, Seminar 79-80 s.3, 15a-GD-Leibniz28April1987-English-Revision-2024.txt, Clastres, Dialogues, Difference and Repetition, Recherches 13, Seminar 1977, Seminar AO 71-72, Seminar Painting 1981, The_Accursed_Share__Volume_1__Consumption.txt

380 Principle and consequence
380 Point one: points serve paths
380 Nomad and migrant
380 Point two: road and trajectory
380 Nomos as distribution
381 Point three: two spaces
381 The territorial principle of the nomad
381 "It is therefore false to define the nomad by movement."
381 Patience
381 Speed and movement
381 Absolute movement
381 Three relations to deterritorialization
382 Local, not global
382 Nomads make the desert
382 The topology of deserts
382 Localized, not delimited
382 The local absolute
382-83 Religion converts the absolute
383 Nomad religion
383 Religions of migration
383-84 Religion as war machine
384 The Crusades
384 Three terms and their mixes
384 Smooth between two striated spaces
384 Components of the State-form as global and relative space
384-85 The Orient's four disadvantages
385 Unity of composition
385 Revolution, West and East
385 A fundamental task of the State
386 Capture of flows
386 Polis, police (Virilio)
386 "Gravity, gravitas, such is the essence of the State."
386 Operations against the State
386 The fortress
386 When striation fails
387 The sea striated first
387 Smooth space reimparted
387 The caution

Proposition VI · 387

Nomad existence necessarily implies the numerical elements of a war machine.
Elsewhere: Seminar 79-80 s.1, Chaosophy, Dialogues, Numbers, Recherches 13

387 Decimal groupings
387-88 A nomad idea

388 "The nomos is fundamentally numerical, arithmetic."
388 Three types of human organization
388 Spatium and extensio
389 The State's arithmetic
389 Three matters the number masters
389 The Numbering Number
389 Small and large quantities
389 Distribution in space
389 Number that moves
389 Geometry's small role
389 Movable and immovable
390 The fire
390 Directional, not dimensional
390 Rhythmic, not harmonic
390 The Cipher
390 The six adjectives
390 Against the "concentration-camp" critique
390-91 Arithmetic composition
391 First characteristic: complex, articulated
391 Units of assemblage
391 Logistics and strategy
391-92 Second characteristic: doubling
392 Genghis Khan and Moses
392 Power in the war machine
392 Three operations of numerical composition
393 Three ways to build the special body
393 Two things to ward off
393 The special body's figures
393 What States do with it
393-94 Geography, not history
394 Two misapplied categories

Proposition VII · 394
Nomad existence has for 'affects' the weapons of a war machine.
Elsewhere: Seminar 79-80 s.1, Chaosophy, Dialogues, Recherches 13

395 Weapons and tools: no intrinsic difference
395 First: projection and introception
395 Centrifugal and centripetal
395 Resistance and counterattack
395 Second: speed (Virilio)
395-96 Hunt and war
396 Animal raisers
396 The economy of violence
396 The Speed vector
396-97 Two objections answered
397 Two ideal models of the motor
397 Moved and self-propelling
397 "The tool does not define work; just the opposite. The tool presupposes work."
397-98 The principle behind all technology
398 Formal causes
398 Genesis and exercise
398 Two systems
398 "Weapons and tools are consequences, nothing but consequences."
398-99 Assemblage cases
399 "Assemblages are passional, they are compositions of desire."
399 State assimilation
399-400 Feeling and affect
400 "Weapons are affects and affects weapons."
400 Martial arts
400 Undoing
400 The void
400-401 Tools and signs
401 The condition of work
401 Weapon and jewelry
401 Free action, not work
401 Not a writing
402 Runic writing: an affective semiotic
402 Assigning assemblages
402 State and nomad affinities
402 The differential method, five points of view
402-3 New alliances
403 Two schizophrenic tastes
403 Jünger's Rebel
403 The new figures
403 Their caricature
403 Technicians

Problem III · 403
How do the nomads invent or find their weapons?
Elsewhere: Seminar 79-80 s.1

Proposition VIII · 404
Metallurgy in itself constitutes a flow necessarily confluent with nomadism.
Elsewhere: Seminar 79-80 s.1, Seminar 79-80 s.13, Seminar 27.2.79, Seminar Painting 1981

404 Nomad innovations
404 Heavy and light
404 Saber and sword
404 The cannon's limit
404-5 The imperial origin of the saber
405 Secrets
405 Metallurgists' autonomy
405 Missing concept
405 Five lines of variation in metallurgy
405-6 Two rubrics
406 Crucible steel and the sword
406 Definition of the machinic phylum
406 The single phylum
406 Definition of an assemblage
406 Assemblages and the phylum
407 Two kinds of line
407 Reciprocal action
407 Matter-flow
407-8 Corporeality's two characteristics
408 Ambulant coupling against sedentary linkage
408 Roundness
408 Simondon against hylomorphism
408 Surrender to the wood
408-9 Translation's cost
409 The middle zone
409 Second definition of the machinic phylum
409 The artisan
409 Second-order and secondary itinerancies
409-10 Flow and circuit
410 Three primary concepts
410 Method of the distinct concept
410 Thresholds
410-11 Three metallurgical examples
411 The ingot-form
411 Metallurgy and music
411 Material vitalism
411 Panmetallism
411 "metallurgy is minor science in person, 'vague' science or the phenomenology of matter."
411 Nonorganic life
411 Alchemy
411-12 The first itinerant
412 The smith's four relations
412 "Every mine is a line of flight."
412 Accommodations on mines
412-13 Mines escape
413 Against the method of myth and ethnology
413 "There are no nomadic or sedentary smiths. Smiths are ambulant, itinerant."
413 Holey space
414 The sign of Cain
414-15 Smiths' relation to others
415 Doubled metallurgists (Childe)
415 Holey space communicates with both
415 Two modes of liaison

Axiom III · 415
The nomad war machine is the form of expression, of which itinerant metallurgy is the correlative form of content.
Elsewhere: Seminar 79-80 s.1, Seminar 79-80 s.13, Seminar Painting 1981

416 The table

Proposition IX · 416
War does not necessarily have the battle as its object, and more important, the war machine does not necessarily have war as its object, although war and the battle may be its necessary result (under certain conditions).
Elsewhere: Seminar 79-80 s.1, Seminar 79-80 s.10, Seminar 79-80 s.12, Seminar 79-80 s.13, Chaosophy, Dialogues, Numbers

416 Three successive problems
416 Battle and nonbattle
416 "the battle and the nonbattle are the double object of war,"
417 The raid
417 The positive object
417 Positive and negative object
417 Three philosophers' grammar of war
417 Moses and Joshua
417-18 War is not the object of States
418 The great question
418 The hypothesis in three points
418-19 Three kinds of problems of appropriation
419-20 Clausewitz's aggregate, three points
420 D&G's criterion
420 The nomads remain an Idea, for two reasons
420 "The question is therefore less the realization of war than the appropriation of the war machine."
420-21 The State's triple evolution
421 Total war and capitalism
421 Aim and object in contradiction
421 The worldwide war machine
421 Clausewitz reversed
422 What we have seen
422 Counterattack
422 The first theoretical element
422 Two poles of the war machine
422 The retraction of Axiom II
422-23 Any movement can be a war machine
423 "It is not the nomad who defines this constellation of characteristics; it is this constellation that defines the nomad, and at the same time the essence of the war machine."
423 Guerrilla, minority, popular war
423 The difference "from the point of view of death."
423 Communication between the poles
423 Incommensurable quantities
423 Last sentence of the plateau

Proposition X · 424
The State and its poles.
Elsewhere: Seminar 79-80 s.1, Seminar 79-80 s.10, Seminar 79-80 s.13, Seminar 79-80 s.2, Seminar 79-80 s.6, Dumézil

424 Dumézil's two theses
424 The One-Eyed and the One-Armed
425 Signs-tools
425 Each pole's way with war
425 State capture and war capture
425 No softening
425 Three regimes of violence in Dumézil's figures
425 Twice the traitor
425 Mutilation comes first
426 Predisabled people
426 The tempting three-part hypothesis, 1-2-3
427 Why the schema cannot be causal, three points
427 Theses on origin are tautological
427 What each presupposes
427 "the unconditioned Urstaat."

Proposition XI · 427
Which comes first?
Elsewhere: Seminar 79-80 s.1, Seminar 79-80 s.10, Seminar 79-80 s.13, Seminar 79-80 s.2, Seminar 79-80 s.3, Seminar 79-80 s.4, Seminar 79-80 s.6, Seminar 79-80 s.7, Braudel, Clastres, Seminar AO 71-72

427 The first pole of capture
427-28 The despot's four roles
428 Bond, Signifier, megamachine
428 Not king, not tyrant
428 The imperial regime
428 The nexum
428 Marx and Childe
428 Çatal Hüyük reverses the givens
428-29 The State creates
429 Two reversals
429 "Like seeds in a sack: It all begins with a chance intermixing."
429 Three challenges to evolutionism
429 Clastres's two theses restated
429 Ethnology against archaeology
429 "Everything is not of the State precisely because there have been States always and everywhere."
429 "Not only does writing presuppose the State, but so do speech and language."
430 Language between groups
430 Everything coexists
430 Three evolutionisms refused
430 Nomadism is a becoming
430 Mechanisms change when autonomous
430 Topology, not succession
430 "All history does is to translate a coexistence of becomings into a succession."
431 Reverse causality
431 The State acts before it appears
431 Three things at once
431 "To ward off is also to anticipate."
431 Presentiment given a positive meaning
431 Two waves
431 Two directions of time
431-32 The threshold
432 Two thresholds, town and State
432-33 Town and State compared
432 Spiritual commerce
433 "Who can say where the greatest civil violence resides?"
433 Lévi-Strauss's two presentations
433 Primitive power
434 Reciprocal presupposition
434 Towns break free
434 "The towns did not create capitalism."
434 Expanded hypothesis
434 Capitalism through the State-form
434-35 The worldwide City
435 The five machinic processes
435 Social topology
435 Extrinsic coexistence
435 The war machine between three organizations
435 Ecumenical organizations before capitalism
435 Diffusion
435 Definition of international organization
435-36 No economic theory of international relations
436 Consolidation, not homogenization
436 Isomorphy, not homogeneity
436-37 Peripheral polymorphy
437 Intrinsic coexistence
437 The power of appropriation
437 The power of transference
437 The power of metamorphosis
437 "Each power is a force of deterritorialization that can go along with the others or go against them (even primitive societies have their vectors of deterritorialization)."

Proposition XII · 437
Capture.
Elsewhere: Seminar 79-80 s.1, Seminar 79-80 s.10, Seminar 79-80 s.13, Seminar 79-80 s.2, Seminar 79-80 s.3, Seminar 79-80 s.4, Seminar 79-80 s.6, Seminar 79-80 s.7, Jevons, Seminar AO 71-72

437 The opening question
437-38 The last
438 "The last as the object of a collective evaluation determines the value of the entire series."
438 Limit and threshold
438-39 Three everyday cases
439 "Exchange is only an appearance."
439 Not labor time

439 Desirability
439 Two sides of every assemblage
439 Serial groups
439 How anticipation-prevention is constituted
440 Stock at the threshold
440 Depletion
440 The threshold already there
440 The stock's correlate
440 Two laws
440 Two kinds of assemblage
440-41 Ground rent
441 The last changes meaning
441 "This is the very model of an apparatus of capture."
441 Land and people
441 Land's two potentialities of deterritorialization
441 "the land is an idea of the town."
441-42 Work as the second correlate
442 Labor and surplus labor
442 Free action before labor
442 Profit as capture
442 Taxation, the third apparatus
442-43 No succession of rents
443 Taxation creates money
443 Two regimes of exchange
443 The tax as first layer of price
443 Productive taxation
443-44 The trinity formula
444 The three numbered theses
444 Space and center
444-45 Semiology
445-46 Schmitt's model, A to D
446 Capture inside, not after
446 "operative."
446 No thief, no victim
446-47 No supplementary explanation
447 The point of inversion
447 State violence is preaccomplished
447 Primitive accumulation enlarged
447-48 Four regimes of violence
448 Monopoly of violence
448 Lawful violence defined
448 The State's alibi

Proposition XIII · 448

The State and its forms.

Elsewhere: Seminar 79-80 s.1, Seminar 79-80 s.10, Seminar 79-80 s.13, Seminar 79-80 s.2, Seminar 79-80 s.3, Seminar 79-80 s.5, Seminar 79-80 s.6, Seminar 79-80 s.7, Seminar 79-80 s.8, Seminar 79-80 s.9, Guattari, Seminar AO 71-72

448 The archaic imperial State's formula
448 The questions
448 "The principle of evolution is internal."
448-49 Definition of decoding
449 Two sources of decoded flows
449 Three escaping flows
449 Tökei's problem
449 Special body and private body
449 "What counts is the collective figure of the Outsider."
450 Childe's thesis
450 Absorbing surplus
450 Where the State was invented
450 The impasse of the oriental solution
450 The Aegean position
450-51 A freer status
451 Surplus value of code, surplus value of flow
451 Bathing in the supranational
451 The second pole of the State, defined
452 Their presuppositions
452 Delirium and law
452 The ambiguity of topical conjunctions
452 Capitalism in negative outline
452 Marx's single Subjectivity
452-53 Two becomings
453 Two inhibitors
453 "capitalism forms with a general axiomatic of decoded flows."
453 Private property mutates
453 Three historical figures of law
453 Does capitalism need a State?
453-54 Two deterritorializations
454 Ecumenical organizations change
454 Capitalism's war cries
454 Axiomatic and code, defined
454 Models of realization
454 "But to exceed is not at all the same thing as doing without."
454 Marx's mechanisms, through States
455 NASA
455 The nation-state's materialist determination
455 "States are not at all transcendent paradigms of an overcoding but immanent models of realization for an axiomatic of decoded flows."
455-56 Three political problems of models
456 The nation
456 "The axiomatic is complex, and is not without passions."
456 Subjectification and subjection
456-57 Machinic enslavement and social subjection, defined
457 Megamachine, not metaphor
457 Technical machines
457 Subjection at its extreme
457 The humanist cry
457-58 Where each appears
458 Three ages of the technical machine
458 Machinic surplus value
458 "a small amount of subjectification took us away from machinic enslavement, but a large amount brings us back to it."
458 Modern power
458 Television
458-59 Not national against worldwide
459 "Rather than stages, subjection and enslavement constitute two coexistent poles."
459 Three major forms of the State
459 Outside and inside
459 Decoded flows and the war machine
459-60 Three correlations
460 "Capitalism has reawakened the Urstaat, and given it new strength."
460 The unique moment of the State
460 The contract
460 Three ages of the knot
460 "Even subjection is only a relay for the fundamental moment of the State, namely, civil capture or machinic enslavement."
460 Neither voluntary nor forced

Proposition XIV · 460

Axiomatics and the present-day situation.

Elsewhere: Seminar 79-80 s.1, Seminar 79-80 s.10, Seminar 79-80 s.11, Seminar 79-80 s.12, Seminar 79-80 s.13, Seminar 79-80 s.3, Seminar 79-80 s.8, Seminar 79-80 s.9, Braudel, Dialogues

461 Politics
461 The axiomatic in science, four features
461 Men of State of science
461 Intuitionism
461 Literal, so open
461 The givens, "a summary sketch."

1. Addition, subtraction (461-63)

461 Operative statements
461-62 Three fates of a flow
462 Adding axioms
462 Domestic and foreign markets
462 The social democratic pole
462 The totalitarian pole
462-63 Fascism distinct

2. Saturation (463-64)

463 Saturation is relative
463 Two tendencies, one axiomatic
463 Against disinterest
463 Struggle over axioms
464 Local struggles, national axioms
464 Living flows and axioms

3. Models, isomorphy (464-66)

464 "In principle, all States are isomorphic; in other words, they are domains of realization of capital as a function of a sole external world market."
464 General rules
464-65 Three bipolarities
465-66 The summary
466 Neither good States nor equivalent States

4. Power (puissance) (466-67)

466 A power of the continuum
466 War of materiel
466 Supersaturation
466 Two conflictual lines
466-67 The inversion completed
467 Virilio's five rigorous points

5. The included middle (468-69)

468 A center
468 The North-South thesis
468 A theoremetic consequence
468 The oldest formula
468 The four principal flows
468 Class rupture
468-69 Center and periphery exchange determinations
469 Negri's internal margin
469 Labor splintered

6. Minorities (469-71)

469 "Ours is becoming the age of minorities."
469 Definition
469 The majority as axiom
469-70 Denumerable and nondenumerable
470 The "and."
470 Fuzzy sets
470 Not viable States
470 The States' response: add axioms
470 The formula for multiplicities
470 Becoming-everybody
470-71 Struggle on axioms is determining
471 The point the axiomatic cannot tolerate
471 The repeated story
471 Two types of propositions
471 The power of minorities
471 The issue

7. Undecidable propositions (471-73)

471 The objection
471 Production of what it exterminates
472 New minorities
472 Integration is not the solution
472 The proletariat
472 No minority States
472 The minorities issue
472 The deepest law of capitalism
472-73 A war machine whose aim is revolutionary movement
473 Not dispersion
473 Constructivism
473 The undecidable, defined
473 "The undecidable is the germ and locus par excellence of revolutionary decisions."
473 Enslavement abounds in them
473 Last sentence of the plateau

Page numbers refer to the Minnesota translation of *A Thousand Plateaus* (1987).

The five machinic processes

Deleuze and Guattari "define social formations by machinic processes and not by modes of production" (435), which is to say that each column below names a process, not a kind of society. In fact, every society has all five "in perpetual interaction" (430), though usually one of them dominates and gives the society its character. They coexist "extrinsically and intrinsically" (435-37), which is to say between societies, as the brackets show, and within each one, as when warding off also operates in towns (the bottom row). Each row puts the same question to all five, while the columns run from the outside, through the inside, to what crosses all of them (Axiom I, 351).

Split cell: a process's own poles or forms · Bracket: a relation joining columns (dotted where it passes over one) · Dashed: either a proposed extension (not a claim of ATP) or a finding from the record that complicates a cell

Question	Warding off PRIMITIVE SOCIETIES	War machine NOMADS	Capture STATES	Polarization TOWNS	Encompassment ECUMENICAL ORGANIZATIONS
What are its poles and forms?	**Segmentary, egalitarian:** anticipates the town (e.g., village halves of equal standing) | **Encompassing, hierarchized:** anticipates the State (e.g., one lineage on top) 433, cf. Lévi-Strauss *Also operates in towns and States, and even in capitalism (e.g., bands with "their own towns") 437* R1	**Creative:** "a creative line of flight" (guerrilla, popular war) | **Destructive:** war as its object (total war, fascism) 422-23, cf. Clausewitz, 420 *Captured by "encastment" (Rome's federated barbarians) or "appropriation proper" (a citizen army) as an army 419, 425, or a "worldwide war machine" of "military-industrial" complexes 387, cf. Virilio* R2	**Binder** (Varuna, Romulus): "capture, bonds, knots, and nets" | **Jurist** (Mitra, Numa): "treaties, pacts, contracts" 351, 424, cf. Dumézil *Three forms: the archaic empire, Marx's "Asiatic formation" (pharaonic Egypt, the Inka), evolved States (Rome's empire, feudal kingdoms, city-states), and nation-States (19th-century France) 427, 451, 459*	**Capital:** the town grows from the palace (Egypt) | **Metropolis:** the palace grows from the town (Sumer, and later Athens) 432 *Commercial towns freed (e.g., the Hanse, Venice), then resubjugated 434*	**Between** formations: trade, metallurgy, religion (e.g., Christianity), art | **Axiomatic:** one world market, "isomorphy" (today) 435-37, cf. Samir Amin *Two poles of the capitalist State: "social democracy" adds axioms, "totalitarianism" subtracts them (Chile) 462-63*
	Primitive mechanisms of war become a nomad war machine "when they gain autonomy" 430				
How is a collective composed?	**Lineal:** by descent, in clan segments that "meld and divide" 388	**Numerical:** tens, hundreds, thousands (the Mongol army, Moses's census in Numbers), with a special body 387-93	**Territorial** ("geometric"): by place, through census, taxation, and election (the voter roll) 388-89	"Physical organization": by entry into circuits (burghers, guilds), under a magistrate 433, 435	*Affiliation across formations (pilgrims, merchant diasporas, converts), for which ATP names no type*
	The numerical composition is "superposed upon the primitive lineal organization" 435				
		Numbering and numbered: one composes a body that moves, the other measures a divided space 387-89			
How is space occupied?	Territory: the earth inscribed by lineages (clan lands), with **itinerancy** from one territory to the next 388, 440	**Smooth:** occupied without being counted (steppe, desert, sea), where points serve paths, and holey with the smiths, for a **nomad** who "does not move" 362 cf. Boulez, 380-81, 413-15 R3	**Striated:** counted in order to be occupied (survey grids, the land register), with the center "on top," and **migrants** controlled 362, 385, 433	Roads and circuits with their entries and exits (market towns, ports), "melodic lines," and the rotation of **transhumance** ("even the merchant") 410, 432, 434	Between formations, as "an intermediate milieu" (trade and pilgrimage routes) 435
		Smooth and striated "exist only in mixture" 474			
			Melodic lines and harmonic cross sections together striate space 434		
How is power exercised?	Chiefs without command (cf. Clastres's Amazonian chiefs), in circles "not concentric" 357, 433	A chief with limited power, and a special body (Genghis Khan's guard) 392	Power "on top": hierarchy, a civil service (scribes, ministries), resonance, global integration 433	Power "of the middle": forced coordination (councils, magistrates), "egalitarian pretensions" 432-33 R4	"The consolidation of the diverse as such" (one church across many kingdoms) 436
	Warding off works against **both** thresholds, State and town 431-33				
			State and town: two thresholds, "two runners" 432-34, cf. Braudel		
How is exchange made?	The **last receivable**, "the law of demand" (ATP's seeds for axes), with depletion warding off the stock 437-40, cf. Jevons		**Comparison and appropriation:** rent, profit, tax on land, tools, money (landowner, entrepreneur, banker) 443-44, cf. Marx's "trinity formula" R5	Commerce, "also spiritual" (merchant leagues, monasteries), recoding decoded flows 432, 434	Long-distance trade (metals since the Neolithic), and one world market under capitalism 435-36
	Limit and threshold: past the threshold, "stockpiling begins" 438-40				
			Proposed: a measure kept in common is not yet capture (RoV 176 n. 3)		
How are activity and matter handled?		**Free action** and the weapon (bow, lance), **following** the phylum (the smith, cf. Childe) 394-411	**Work** and the tool (the plow, the daily quota), and **hylomorphism**, form imposed on matter (the mold, cf. Simondon) 369, 397-98, 408	Makes the phylum "pass through specific places" (markets, workshops) 432	Metallurgy cuts across formations (bronze, iron) 435
		Free action and work: work is free action captured, measured, stocked 441-42			
How is knowledge made?	Territorial codes (kin rules, ritual)	**Nomad science:** problematic and following (Gothic builders, smiths, navigators), with the cipher and the secret 361-74, 390	**Royal science:** theoremetic and reproducing (Euclid, State engineering), with the State form of thought 361-76 R6	Frequency, "melodic lines" 434	Translation, religions, art (scripture carried across languages) 430, 436
		One field of interaction: royal science appropriates, nomad science cuts loose, through "vague essences" 367, cf. Husserl			
How is violence exercised?	**Struggle:** blow for blow, coded (the feud) 447	**War**, against the State (raids), yet not its object 416-18	**Policing**, capturing while "constituting a right to capture" (police, courts, prisons), against **crime**, capturing what one has no "right" to capture (theft) 447-48, cf. Marx on primitive accumulation R7	*Civil violence ("Who can say ...?" 433)*	*Violence carried across societies, as in West African slave-raiding (Meillassoux)*
		The State "has no war machine of its own" 355			
How are persons captured or freed?		The special body: slaves who become soldiers (Mamluks, Janissaries) 393	Machinic **enslavement** (galley rowers, app-directed work) and social **subjection** (worker, citizen), the "megamachine" 428 cf. Mumford, 456-59	*The town as refuge, from early cities of the displaced (Yoffee) to Teotihuacan in Mexico (Manzanilla)*	*Enslavement across societies: the Atlantic slave system*
What does it prevent, and what escapes it?	Wards off the State and the town, or any change past its limit (dispersal, sharing) 431-33	Wards off lineal aristocracy, imperial functionaries 393	Decoded flows (private debt, runaways) and minorities 448, 469-73	Wards off the State-form and capitalism (medieval Italian and Hanseatic towns), then resubjugated 434	Its own "bands, deserts, war machines" (Christianity's desert monks) 436
			The axiomatic: capitalism wins "through the State-form," works "like a single City," and worldwide organization "becomes the capitalist axiomatic" 434-36		
What is its limit?	The **last**, limit of an ordinal series (the last ax), keeping the threshold "at a distance" 438-40	*Open: ATP names none*	The **threshold**, "the lowest element in a cardinal set" (the least fertile land) 441	*Open: ATP names none*	**Its own limits**, which capitalism confronts and "displaces" at once (oil, nuclear power) 463
	Each process has a limit of its own (cf. Sibertin-Blanc, 55)				
How does it pass into the others?	"Each process can also function at a 'power' other than its own": the State appropriates the war machine, the instruments of polarization, and warding off, which also operates in towns, States, and even capitalism 437				
Where is capitalism?	Not a sixth column. Social formations are defined "by machinic processes and not by modes of production" 435, and capitalism is composed from the five: it wins "through the State-form and not the town-form" and resubjugates the towns 434, the ecumenical takes on "a consistency of its own" and "distributes these formations" 454, and warding off moves into capitalism "insofar as it wards off and repels its own limits" 437				

The five machinic processes, with marronage

Protevi's marronage column is tentative. He announces "a becoming-maroon" (RoV 96), describes marronage as "a set of interlinking processes" (108), and later treats maroon societies as a mix of prevention-anticipation, war machines, "and perhaps ecumenical" processes (119). Is marronage a process of its own, or a mix of the others? The column sits between the war machine and capture because, for Protevi, the maroon zone is "neither 'smooth' nor 'striated'" (104).

Split cell: poles or forms · ATP's relations between columns (on paper, see the front) · Protevi's relations between marronage and capture · Dashed: a proposed extension, or a finding from the record · IN MAROON SOCIETIES processes Protevi finds in them (RoV 119)

Question	Warding off PRIMITIVE SOCIETIES IN MAROON SOCIETIES (PROTEVI)	War machine NOMADS IN MAROON SOCIETIES (PROTEVI)	Marronage MAROON SOCIETIES (TENTATIVE)	Capture STATES	Polarization TOWNS	Encompassment ECUMENICAL ORGANIZATIONS "PERHAPS" IN THEM (PROTEVI)
What are its poles and forms?	**Segmentary, egalitarian**: anticipates the town (e.g., village halves of equal standing) | **Encompassing, hierarchized**: anticipates the State (e.g., one lineage on top) 433, cf. Lévi-Strauss *Also operates in towns and States, and even in capitalism (e.g., bands with "their own towns") 437* R1	**Creative**: "a creative line of flight" (guerrilla, popular war) | **Destructive**: war as its object (total war, fascism) 422-23, cf. Clausewitz, 420 *Captured by "encastment" (Rome's federated barbarians) or "appropriation proper" (a citizen army) as an army 419, 425, or a "worldwide war machine" of "military-industrial" complexes 387, cf. Virilio* R2	**Wild**: outside the plantation but near enough to trade and raid (e.g., Jamaica's mountains) | **Urban**: "hiding in plain sight" (forged papers in a city) RoV 109 *State-establishing maroons or Haiti's counter-plantation RoV 104, as "tendencies," not types RoV 109* Proposed: *Three operations: putting the plantation to flight in place, leaving it, and occupying a space without leaving*	**Binder** (Varuna, Romulus): "capture, bonds, knots, and nets" | **Jurist** (Mitra, Numa): "treaties, pacts, contracts" 351, 424, cf. Dumézil *Three forms: the archaic empire, Marx's "Asiatic formation" (pharaonic Egypt, the Inka), evolved States (Rome's empire, feudal kingdoms, city-states), and nation-States (19th-century France) 427, 451, 459*	**Capital**: the town grows from the palace (Egypt) | **Metropolis**: the palace grows from the town (Sumer, and later Athens) 432 *Commercial towns freed (e.g., the Hanse, Venice), then resubjugated 434*	**Between** formations: trade, metallurgy, religion (e.g., Christianity), art | **Axiomatic**: one world market, "isomorphy" (today) 435-37, cf. Samir Amin *Two poles of the capitalist State: "social democracy" adds axioms, "totalitarianism" subtracts them (Chile) 462-63*
How is a collective composed?	**Lineal**: by descent, in clan segments that "meld and divide" 388	**Numerical**: tens, hundreds, thousands (the Mongol army, Moses's census in Numbers), with a special body 387-93	Initiation for "multiple African origins," with deserters executed RoV 117 Proposed: *Brazil's campo negro: networks tying runaway camps to slave quarters and markets (Gomes)*	**Territorial** ("geometric"): by place, through census, taxation, and election (the voter roll) 388-89	"Physical organization": by entry into circuits (burghers, guilds), under a magistrate 433, 435	*Affiliation across formations (pilgrims, merchant diasporas, converts), for which ATP names no type*
How is space occupied?	Territory: the earth inscribed by lineages (clan lands), with **itinerancy** from one territory to the next 388, 440	**Smooth**: occupied without being counted (steppe, desert, sea), where points serve paths, and holey with the smiths, for a **nomad** who "does not move" 362 cf. Boulez, 380-81, 413-15 R3	"Neither 'smooth' nor 'striated'" but "secluded or marginal," with ambush points and hidden defenses RoV 104, 120 Proposed: *Holey space: a 1769 map of a Brazilian runaway community, with smithies and "holes for escape" (Carney and Rosomoff)*	**Striated**: counted in order to be occupied (survey grids, the land register), with the center "on top," and **migrants** controlled 362, 385, 433	Roads and circuits with their entries and exits (market towns, ports), "melodic lines," and the rotation of **transhumance** ("even the merchant") 410, 432, 434	Between formations, as "an intermediate milieu" (trade and pilgrimage routes) 435
How is power exercised?	Chiefs without command (cf. Clastres's Amazonian chiefs), in circles "not concentric" 357, 433	A chief with limited power, and a special body (Genghis Khan's guard) 392	Palmares, a 17th-century Brazilian runaway polity, as "kingdom" or "republic," and Haiti's counter-plantation, "without an apparatus of capture" RoV 104, 118 "A capture of the apparatus of capture itself" RoV 104	Power "on top": hierarchy, a civil service (scribes, ministries), resonance, global integration 433	Power "of the middle": forced coordination (councils, magistrates), "egalitarian pretensions" 432-33 R4	"The consolidation of the diverse as such" (one church across many kingdoms) 436
How is exchange made?	The **last receivable**, "the law of demand" (ATP's seeds for axes), with depletion warding off the stock 437-40, cf. Jevons		"Trade, raid, tribute, and treaty" RoV 103 Flight is "co-constitutive of states" RoV 115	**Comparison and appropriation**: rent, profit, tax on land, tools, money (landowner, entrepreneur, banker) 443-44, cf. Marx's "trinity formula" R5	Commerce, "also spiritual" (merchant leagues, monasteries), recoding decoded flows 432, 434	Long-distance trade (metals since the Neolithic), and one world market under capitalism 435-36
How are activity and matter handled?		**Free action** and the weapon (bow, lance), **following** the phylum (the smith, cf. Childe) 394-411	Hunting and swidden "adapted to ... the risk of attack" RoV 117 Proposed: *Maroon farming and smithing in Brazilian runaway communities (Carney and Rosomoff)*	**Work** and the tool (the plow, the daily quota), and **hylomorphism**, form imposed on matter (the mold, cf. Simondon) 369, 397-98, 408	Makes the phylum "pass through specific places" (markets, workshops) 432	Metallurgy cuts across formations (bronze, iron) 435
How is knowledge made?	Territorial codes (kin rules, ritual)	**Nomad science**: problematic and following (Gothic builders, smiths, navigators), with the cipher and the secret 361-74, 390	Marronage as a "figure" in Glissant and other Caribbean writers RoV 121 Proposed: *Knowledge kept by restriction, as in Saramaka history told in fragments (Richard Price) or Jamaican "Maroon Science" (Bilby)*	**Royal science**: theorematic and reproducing (Euclid, State engineering) with the State form of thought 361-76 R6	Frequency, "melodic lines" 434	Translation, religions, art (scripture carried across languages) 430, 436
How is violence exercised?	**Struggle**: blow for blow, coded (the feud) 447	**War**, against the State (raids), yet not its object 416-18	"Its own regime of violence": raiding, defensive war, return of runaways RoV 117 **Mastery** and **marronage**: Protevi's added regimes RoV 115-17	**Policing**, capturing while "constituting a right to capture" (police, courts, prisons), against **crime**, capturing what one has no "right" to capture (theft) 447-48, cf. Marx on primitive accumulation R7	*Civil violence ("Who can say ...?" 433)*	*Violence carried across societies, as in West African slave-raiding (Meillassoux)*
How are persons captured or freed?		The special body: slaves who become soldiers (Mamluks, Janissaries) 393	Captives held "to ensure acculturation," and marginality as "becoming free" RoV 109, 117 R8 Treaty maroons "assist in pursuit, capture, and return" RoV 117	Machinic **enslavement** (galley rowers, app-directed work) and social **subjection** (worker, citizen), the "megamachine" 428 cf. Mumford, 456-59	*The town as refuge, from early cities of the displaced (Yoffee) to Teotihuacan in Mexico (Manzanilla)*	*Enslavement across societies: the Atlantic slave system*
What does it prevent, and what escapes it?	Wards off the State and the town, or any change past its limit (dispersal, sharing) 431-33	Wards off lineal aristocracy, imperial functionaries 393	"Not anti-State; they seek to be autonomous" RoV 104	Decoded flows (private debt, runaways) and minorities 448, 469-73	Wards off the State-form and capitalism (medieval Italian and Hanseatic towns), then resubjugated 434	Its own "bands, deserts, war machines" (Christianity's desert monks) 436
What is its limit?	The **last**, limit of an ordinal series (the last ax), keeping the threshold "at a distance" 438-40	*Open: ATP names none*		The **threshold**, "the lowest element in a cardinal set" (the least fertile land) 441	*Open: ATP names none*	**Its own limits**, which capitalism confronts and "displaces" at once (oil, nuclear power) 463
How does it pass into the others?	"Each process can also function at a 'power' other than its own": the State appropriates the war machine, the instruments of polarization, and warding off, which also operates in towns, States, and even capitalism 437 Protevi: "state-establishing maroons" can "partake in the machinic process of overcoding" RoV 103					
Where is capitalism?	Not a sixth column. Social formations are defined "by machinic processes and not by modes of production" 435, and capitalism is composed from the five: it wins "through the State-form and not the town-form" and resubjugates the towns 434, the ecumenical takes on "a consistency of its own" and "distributes these formations" 454, and warding off moves into capitalism "insofar as it wards off and repels its own limits" 437					

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Notes and sources

The markers R1-R8 on the two charts point to findings from anthropology, archaeology, and history that complicate a cell or dispute it outright. Below them is a key to every scholar and place named on the charts, including the thinkers whose concepts Deleuze and Guattari borrow (marked "cf."), so that readers new to these literatures can follow along without a library.

Findings from the record

R1 What are its poles and forms? · Warding off Ethnography complicates warding off, since among the Pintupi of Australia's Western Desert, control of ritual knowledge founds rank as "looking after" (Myers), while in Tonga the communities that resisted their chiefs' extraction came to stress women's reproductive roles, which lowered women's standing (Gailey).

R2 What are its poles and forms? · War machine Can a war machine found a State? Historians of the Mongol steppe disagree. For Munkh-Erdene the warband of a charismatic warlord is the "nomadic origin of the state," whereas for Di Cosmo steppe states formed "in relation to sedentary states" such as China, which leaves the question open.

R3 How is space occupied? · War machine Anthropologists of Inner Asia have dropped "nomadism" in favor of "mobile pastoralism" (Humphrey and Sneath), much as ancient DNA studies measure migration. Yet for Deleuze and Guattari it is "false to define the nomad by movement" (381), so the specialists and the plateaus are not arguing about the same thing.

R4 How is power exercised? · Polarization Archaeology reopens the question of which threshold comes first. Sumer's city-states are ATP's own "town solution" (432), the Indus cities had writing and standard weights but no palaces (Green), and every place name recorded in Uruk-period Mesopotamia is the name of a city (Moreno García and Richardson).

R5 How is exchange made? · Capture Studies of hunter-gatherers suggest that setting food aside does not yet make a stock, which requires rights converging "upon a single interest" (Ingold). Indeed, Testart calls the order of storage and settled life "chicken-and-egg." Both tell against the storage-first account Protevi takes up (RoV 98).

R6 How is knowledge made? · Capture In ancient Egypt and Babylonia, fields were measured by a dozen kinds of officer with no fixed competence, which is to say royal measure without a royal science (Moreno García and Richardson).

R7 How is violence exercised? · Capture In Middle Bronze Age Mesopotamia, violence by State and community was "rare in fact," with sanction running instead through reputation and exclusion, a regime missing from Deleuze and Guattari's four (Garfinkle and Richardson).

R8 How are persons captured or freed? · Marronage Old Babylonian law (about 1900-1600 BCE) treated a slave's flight as theft by whoever helped, not as the fugitive's own act (Richardson). Even whether flight counts as the fugitive's act, then, depends on the regime.

Who and what is named

Amin, Samir
Deleuze and Guattari side with the economist Samir Amin, a theorist of world-systems and unequal development, in holding that "there can be no economic theory of international relations," which is the ground of the ecumenical (435-36).

Bilby, Kenneth
For the anthropologist Kenneth Bilby, in *True-Born Maroons* (2005), the Jamaican Maroons keep a knowledge they call "Maroon Science," learned through "testing and evasion."

Boulez, Pierre
Smooth and striated space come from the composer Pierre Boulez, who distinguished musical time counted in advance from time occupied without being counted (362, 477-78).

Braudel, Fernand
Fernand Braudel describes the State and the town as "two runners" in the history of European capitalism, an image Deleuze and Guattari quote (434).

Carney, Judith, and Richard Rosomoff
In *In the Shadow of Slavery* (2009), the geographers Judith Carney and Richard Rosomoff reproduce a 1769 militia map of a runaway community in Minas Gerais, Brazil, marking its smithies and gardens beside hidden defenses and "holes for escape" (85).

Casimir, Jean
The Haitian historian Jean Casimir shows in *The Haitians* (2020) how cultivators after the revolution built a "counter-plantation" of family farms and, "without moving from the plantations," stopped being the plantation's workers (142), a book Protevi also cites (RoV 104).

Childe, V. Gordon
Deleuze and Guattari take the itinerant smith, who follows metal, from V. Gordon Childe, an archaeologist of prehistoric Europe who also dug in the Near East (412, 415).

Clastres, Pierre
Warding off begins with the anthropologist Pierre Clastres, whose *Society against the State* (1974) describes Amazonian chiefs who speak but cannot command (357-59).

Clausewitz, Carl von
The war machine's two poles rework the distinction that the Prussian theorist Carl von Clausewitz draws between absolute war as an Idea and the real wars that States fight (420-23).

Di Cosmo, Nicola
In *Ancient China and Its Enemies* (2002), the historian Nicola Di Cosmo has the Xiongnu state form in reaction to China, adopting forms of sedentary states as it did so (171).

Dumézil, Georges
Sovereignty's two heads (Varuna the binder against Mitra the jurist) come from Georges Dumézil's comparative history of Indo-European religion (351, 424).

Gailey, Christine Ward
Christine Ward Gailey's *Kinship to Kingship* (1987) treats state formation in Tonga as a process, one in which communities resisting the chiefs' extraction came to stress women's reproductive roles, so that women's status fell (xi).

Garfinkle, Steven, and Seth Richardson
For Middle Bronze Age Mesopotamia (about 2000-1600 BCE), the historians Steven Garfinkle and Seth Richardson find State and community violence "rare in fact," with sanction running instead through reputation and exclusion (161).

Glissant, Édouard
The Martinican writer Édouard Glissant, among the Caribbean writers Protevi cites, takes the maroon as a figure of resistance (RoV 121).

Gomes, Flávio dos Santos
Quilombos are Brazil's runaway communities. The historian Flávio dos Santos Gomes calls the networks tying them to slave quarters, the free poor, and traders a *campo negro*, a formation "inside slavery and an alternative to it."

Green, Adam
In "Killing the Priest-King" (2021), the archaeologist Adam Green describes Indus cities (about 2600-1900 BCE) with writing, standard weights, seals, and metalwork, yet no palaces or royal tombs.

Humphrey, Caroline, and David Sneath
Writing on Mongolia and Inner Asia in *The End of Nomadism?* (1999), the anthropologists Caroline Humphrey and David Sneath call nomadism "a category imagined by outsiders" and prefer "mobile pastoralism" (1).

Husserl, Edmund
Nomad science takes its anexact rigor from Edmund Husserl's "vague essences," roundness as opposed to the circle (367).

Indus, Sumer, Uruk
The Indus civilization flourished in present-day Pakistan and northwest India (about 2600-1900 BCE). Sumer names the city-states of southern Mesopotamia (from about 2900 BCE), while the period of Uruk, a Mesopotamian city (about 4000-3100 BCE), gives the earliest writing, kept as accounts.

Ingold, Tim
For the anthropologist Tim Ingold, setting food aside is not yet a stock, since a stock is rights converging "upon a single interest" (1983, 553).

Jevons, W. Stanley
The limit and threshold of warding off borrow "the last" unit from the marginalist economist Jevons, whom Deleuze and Guattari dub "a kind of Lewis Carroll of economics" (437).

Lévi-Strauss, Claude
Claude Lévi-Strauss showed that the same village can present itself as segmentary and egalitarian or as encompassing and hierarchized, two potentials that Deleuze and Guattari treat as anticipations of town and State (433).

Manzanilla, Linda
The archaeologist Linda Manzanilla studies Teotihuacan, a city of central Mexico (about 100 BCE-550 CE) founded largely by people displaced by a volcanic eruption, governed corporately, and burned at its center around 550 CE.

Marx, Karl
From Karl Marx come ATP's archaic State, his "Asiatic formation" (427), the "trinity formula" behind rent and profit as well as tax (443), and the primitive accumulation behind State violence (447).

Meillassoux, Claude
In *The Anthropology of Slavery* (1986), the French anthropologist Claude Meillassoux shows a West African slave system joining the societies raided for captives, the aristocracies that raid them, and the merchants who sell the captives (74).

Moreno García, Juan Carlos, and Seth Richardson
In *Monarchies and the Organization of Power* (2025), the historians Juan Carlos Moreno García and Seth Richardson find Egyptian and Babylonian kings co-opting local powers they could not erase (6), with fields measured by many kinds of officer (16).

Mumford, Lewis
Machinic enslavement takes its image from the historian Lewis Mumford's "megamachine," the archaic empire as a machine made of people (428, 457).

Munkh-Erdene, Lhamsuren
In *The Nomadic Leviathan* (2023), the Mongolian historian Lhamsuren Munkh-Erdene argues "for the nomadic origin of the state" in the warband of a charismatic warlord (1, 25).

Myers, Fred
Among the Pintupi of Australia's Western Desert, as the anthropologist Fred Myers describes them in *Pintupi Country, Pintupi Self* (1986), authority rests in the Law, outside any living person, even as elders' ritual knowledge founds rank as "looking after" (220-21).

Palmares
Palmares was a large runaway polity in 17th-century Brazil, which historians have described either as a kingdom or as a "republic" (RoV 118).

Price, Richard
In *First-Time* (1983), the anthropologist Richard Price records how the Saramaka of Suriname keep the history of their ancestors' war against the planters restricted, telling it only in fragments.

Richardson, Seth
The historian of Mesopotamia Seth Richardson shows that Old Babylonian law treated flight as theft by whoever helped the slave (2023, 19-20).

Sibertin-Blanc, Guillaume
In *State and Politics: Deleuze and Guattari on Marx* (2016), the philosopher Guillaume Sibertin-Blanc treats plateaus 12-13 as a theory of violence. For him each process meets a limit of its own, so that warding off, polarization, capture, and deployment in smooth space each reach a point past which they fail (55).

Simondon, Gilbert
Following matter, as opposed to imposing form, draws on the philosopher Gilbert Simondon's critique of the form-matter, or hylomorphic, model (408).

Testart, Alain
For the French anthropologist Alain Testart, the order of storage and settled life among hunter-gatherers is "a chicken-and-egg question" (1982, 524).

Three operations of marronage
The sheet proposes three operations of marronage, namely putting a system to flight in place, leaving it, and holding a space without leaving it.

Virilio, Paul
The "worldwide war machine" draws on Paul Virilio, a theorist of speed and war, and his "fleet in being," which holds the sea from any point (387).

Yoffee, Norman
In *Myths of the Archaic State* (2005), the archaeologist Norman Yoffee treats early cities as refuges and nomadism as something urban life produces (60).

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Nomadology's two sciences

Working out the thrust of the stone on site rather than from an architect's plan on paper, the Gothic journeymen who raised the cathedrals practiced what Deleuze and Guattari call a **minor** or nomad science (364-68). Such a science follows its material and poses problems that it cannot solve on its own (how to vault a nave higher than the Romanesque, for instance). As a result, its findings tend to be taken over by the **royal** science of the State, which reproduces, deduces, and extracts constants. But the two are not simply opposed, as they share "a single field of interaction" (367) in which what one appropriates, the other is forever cutting loose again. And it is this borderline that the middle column records, whether the passage is by translation, appropriation, repression, or the cutting loose of what was taken. Altogether, the sheet serves as a companion to *The five machinic processes*, which gives the whole matter a single row ("How is knowledge made?").

The borderline: translation, appropriation, repression, cutting loose · Dashed: a proposed extension, not a claim of ATP · R Finding from the record

Question	Royal science THE STATE'S SCIENCE	The borderline WHERE ONE PASSES INTO THE OTHER	Minor science NOMAD, AMBULANT, VAGUE
What is its model?	A theory of **solids**, treating fluids as a special case, and a model of the stable, the eternal, the identical, the constant (Euclid, Plato's *Timaeus*) 361	In the *Timaeus*, Plato raises becoming as a model "only in order to exclude it and conjure it away in the name of royal science" 361	A **hydraulic** model, in which "flux is reality itself," a model of becoming and heterogeneity, with the clinamen as the smallest deviation of an atom (Democritus, Lucretius, cf. Serres) 361
In what space does it work?	**Striated** or metric space, "counted in order to be occupied," the homogeneous space of gravity, "the space of pillars" 362, 370	Smooth space is "always translatable, and necessarily translated," by laying a Euclidean space over each of its points, "the triumph of the logos or the law over the nomos" 373	**Smooth** space, topological instead of metric, "occupied without being counted," a space of contact that can "be explored only by legwork" 362, 371
At what speed, to what rhythm?	**Gravitas**: laminar movement from point to point, and a "measured, cadenced" rhythm, like a river between its banks 363-64, 371	Their opposition is qualitative, a condition "that regulates both the separation and the mixing of the two models" 371	**Celeritas**: the movement that deviates and becomes vortical, and "a rhythm without measure," like the upswell of a flood 364, 371
How does it treat a figure?	**Theorematic**: from an essence to its properties, from a genus to its species, with the circle as "an organic, ideal, fixed essence" 362, 367	Royal science reduces "the 'problem-element'" and subordinates it to "the 'theorem-element'" 362	**Problematic**: figures as events (no square without a quadrature), and roundness as a vague essence, "anexact yet rigorous" (cf. Husserl) 362, 367
What does an equation do?	It extracts constants from variables, "an invariable form for variables," which Deleuze and Guattari call the **compars** 369 R4	Differential calculus was admitted as "a well-founded fiction" once its "dynamic, nomadic notions" had been eliminated (Carnot) 363	It puts variables into continuous variation ("adequations, inequations, differential equations"), the **dispars**, with equations generated by the material "as 'forces of thrust'" (the Gothic vault) 364-65, 369
How does it proceed?	**Reproducing**: iteration, deduction, induction, from a fixed point of view, "watching the flow from the bank" 372	"The question is not whether such a translation is conceptually legitimate - it is - but what intuition gets lost in it" 409	**Following**: itineration across a field where singularities are "scattered like so many 'accidents' (problems)" (the smith, the Gothic journeyman) 372, 409 R2
How do matter and form relate?	**Hylomorphism**: a form that organizes a matter prepared for it, a schema derived from "a society divided into governors and governed" 369	Between form and matter lies "a zone of medium and intermediary dimension" that the model cannot see (cf. Simondon) 408-09	**Material-forces**: matter "laden with singularities" and expression with "pertinent traits," so that one addresses "a materiality possessing a nomos" (splitting wood along its grain) 369, 408 R3
What plane does it draw?	The architect's metric plane, "on paper and off site," a plane of organization, with stone cut by templates as a model "for reproduction" 365, 368	Bernard de Clairvaux gave up founding Gothic building on Euclid as too "difficult" and turned to "an operative, Archimedean geometry" 364	The journeyman's ground-level plane, which is the plane of consistency, with stone cut by squaring, so that "the cutting line propels the equation" (Garin de Troyes) 364, 368
What division of labor does it assume?	The split between intellectual and manual labor, "modeled upon the difference between 'governors' and 'governed,'" with labor dequalified 368	The State represses nomad science not for being inexact but "because they imply a division of labor opposed to the norms of the State" 368	The itinerant bodies of masons, carpenters, smiths and the like (the compagnonnages), whose powers are "mobility and the strike," and the artisan who must also prospect 368, 409
How autonomous is it?	Autonomous, with "a metric power" that isolates its operations from intuition as "true intrinsic concepts, or 'categories'" 373-74 R1	The ambulant sciences invent problems whose "scientific solution depends ... on royal science" (cf. Bergson's intuition and intelligence) 374	Not autonomous: its solutions are "tied to a whole set of collective, nonscientific activities," and "problematics is still its only mode" 373-74
Who practices it, and what happens to them?	"The men of State of science," the great axiomaticians, "heirs of the theorematic conception of geometry" 461	Savants "between a rock and a hard place," above all the military engineer, used by State science "only after restraining or disciplining them" (Vauban, Monge, Carnot) 362-63	Archimedes "vanquished by the Roman State," Desargues "condemned by the parlement of Paris," the Gothic guilds banned, Perronet's bridges 362, 365 R5
What is its exemplary science?	Gravity, "the law of all laws," and geometry, so that "even chemistry became a royal science only by virtue of ... the notion of weight" 370	Each new field of science "proved irreducible to the field of attraction ... although not contradictory" to it, lodging itself in "an excess" 370	Metallurgy, "minor science in person, 'vague' science or the phenomenology of matter," and the smith who follows the ore 411-12
What does it do with problems?	It answers them with an **axiomatic**, "a stopping point, a reordering" that keeps decoded flows from "escaping in all directions" 461	Intuitionism opposed axiomatics "in the name of a calculus of problems," an abstract machine "working in the undecidable and the fugitive" 461	It poses them, as a constructivism "operating by the determination of the conditions of the problem and by transversal links between problems" 473
Where is it now?	*Machine learning predicts from data without a model of the process (cf. Breiman's "two cultures"), which makes it perhaps a royal science that has learned to follow*	*A measure kept in common (the sealings of Sabi Abyad, the Indus weights) against a measure owned by one party and applied to others (the platform's reputation score)*	*Knowledge kept by restriction and evasion, as in the Jamaican Maroons' "Maroon Science" (Bilby) or Saramaka history told in fragments (Price)*
How do the two meet?	"Two formally different conceptions of science, and, ontologically, a single field of interaction in which royal science continually appropriates the contents of vague or nomad science while nomad science continually cuts the contents of royal science loose. At the limit, all that counts is the constantly shifting borderline" 367		

Page numbers refer to the Minnesota translation of *A Thousand Plateaus* (1987). Bold type marks the two terms of a contrast. Dashed cells are proposed extensions, not claims made in *A Thousand Plateaus*. Markers R1-R5 point to findings from the record, listed on the notes page. The two sciences are worked out in Deleuze's seminar of 26 February 1980 (Euclid and Archimedes, Desargues, Monge, Poncelet, the intuitionists) and of 27 February 1979 (Husserl's vague essences, Simondon); passages in *work/context/*.

Working with another field

A nomadology can thus work with anthropology, archaeology, and history without taking on their frame along with their findings. Many of the questions these fields ask, such as how the State originated or who lived free of it, are asked from the side of the State, and each row below turns one of them into a question that a nomadology can pursue, with the pages that ground it and a case from the specialist literature.

Instead of asking	A nomadology asks	ATP	A case
CAPTURE COMES SECOND			
How did the State originate?	**For (allegedly) self-founding forms of power, what did they convert to look that way?**	427, 446-48	Will on Corinth: money came from taxation, not trade (442)
Did storage cause inequality?	**When something is stored, is it a reserve kept in common, or a stock drawn toward a single interest?**	440-44	Ingold: a stock is rights converging "upon a single interest"
COEXISTENCE			
Which came first?	**How does a balance of forces sense possible changes in kind, and how is such a change prevented or precipitated?**	431-39	Lévi-Strauss: one village, two potentials, segmentary or hierarchized (433)
Is this a State society or not?	**Which processes coexist in a formation, and which one do the others serve?**	435-37	Green: Indus cities with writing and weights but no palaces
When did capitalism begin? Did trade create it?	**If capitalism is not a unique process all its own, which processes compose it, and what forms of power operate within it?**	434-37, 453-54	Braudel: a world-economy always has "a dominant capitalist city" at its center
THE OUTSIDE			
Which peoples were really nomads?	**Without a power above to constitute it as a people, how does a way of life thicken its consistency enough to hold together?**	420-23	Lindner: a nomadic tribe made by recruitment and defection, not descent
Who lived free of the State?	**What relations take a form that no State can make interior, even inside its borders?**	359-60	Casimir: cultivators who stopped being the plantation's workers without leaving it
SPACE AND NUMBER			
How mobile were they?	**How is a space inhabited without settling in the midst of what would divide it, and how does it stay undivided while open to the outside?**	380-81, 413-15	Humphrey and Sneath prefer "mobile pastoralism," yet movement is not what defines the nomad (381)
How was the population counted?	**For a composed body, how is it counted: as a sequence on the move, or as shares of a whole?**	387-92	Sabi Abyad: sealings from stores shared "probably along egalitarian lines" (Frangipane)
How many escaped?	**What does a flight keep uncountable on purpose, and what can no count of it decide?**	469-70	Price: Saramaka history kept restricted and in fragments
MINOR SCIENCE			
What do the data show?	**What was set aside as noise so that a record could be compared, and what would following it show?**	373, 409	Moreno García and Richardson: royal measure without a royal science
What constants can we extract?	**Does a practice watch the flow from the bank or follow it, and which does research do?**	372	Carney and Rosomoff: maroon smithies on a 1769 map
Was this knowledge accurate?	**What makes a knowledge rigorous when it is not exact, like roundness rather than the circle?**	367	Bilby: "Maroon Science," learned through "testing and evasion"
What form was imposed?	**When a form is imposed from outside, what is presumed incapable of organizing itself, and what would following the grain of the material do instead?**	369, 408-09	Simondon: splitting wood along its fibers
Who designed this?	**Whom does a knowledge assume will think and whom will work, and what is lost when the two are split?**	368-69	The Gothic journeymen against the architect's plane on paper (368)
PROBLEMS AND AXIOMS			
What is the solution?	**As operating rules are added or removed, what of a fuzzy multiplicity do they contain, and what evades them?**	461-62, 470-73	Babylonian kings canceled debts to "restore order," though for Hudson "the clean slate actually improved the ruler's own fiscal position"
Were they warlike?	**How does a power present its own violence, and what does it make of the violence of others?**	447-48	Garfinkle and Richardson: violence "rare in fact," with reputation and exclusion doing the work
Was this resistance or destruction?	**When a flight breaks with an order, does it make new relations, or only abolish the old ones?**	422-23	Munkh-Erdene: the warband of a warlord as the "nomadic origin of the state"

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Notes and sources

The markers R1-R5 on the front point to findings from anthropology, archaeology, and history that complicate a cell. Below them is a key to every scholar and place named on the sheet.

Findings from the record

R1 How autonomous is it? · Royal science In ancient Egypt and Babylonia, fields were measured by a dozen kinds of officer, none of them with a fixed competence, which amounts to a royal measure without a royal science (Moreno García and Richardson).

R2 How does it proceed? · Minor science Even following can be enlisted by the State. Tracking, which Louis Liebenberg presents as the origin of science among Kalahari hunters, is today the craft of the Shadow Wolves, a United States border unit of Native American trackers.

R3 How do matter and form relate? · Minor science On a 1769 militia map of a runaway community in Minas Gerais, Brazil, the smithies and gardens are marked beside the hidden defenses and "holes for escape" (Carney and Rosomoff, 85).

R4 What does an equation do? · Royal science More telling still, the Indus cities had standard weights, seals, and writing but no palaces or royal tombs (Green), so that a fixed measure need not belong to a palace.

R5 Who practices it, and what happens to them? · Minor science Although it is often taken for a thing of the past, minor science still has practitioners. The Jamaican Maroons learn their "Maroon Science" through "testing and evasion" (Bilby), while the Saramaka of Suriname keep the history of their war against the planters restricted and in fragments (Price).

Who and what is named

Archimedes, Democritus, Lucretius
Deleuze and Guattari take these as the ancient sources of minor science, namely Archimedes' geometry of curves and the atomism of Democritus and Lucretius, as Michel Serres treats them (361-62).

Bergson, Henri
Deleuze and Guattari find the relation between the two sciences "somewhat like intuition and intelligence in Bergson," where only intelligence can solve formally the problems that intuition poses (374).

Bernard de Clairvaux, Garin de Troyes
Bernard of Clairvaux, abbot in the twelfth century, together with Garin, by legend his monk-mason, whose "operative logic of movement" stands for the geometry of the Gothic journeymen (364).

Bilby, Kenneth
For the anthropologist Kenneth Bilby, in *True-Born Maroons* (2005), the Jamaican Maroons keep a knowledge they call "Maroon Science," learned through "testing and evasion."

Braudel, Fernand
Fernand Braudel describes the State and the town as "two runners" in the history of European capitalism, an image Deleuze and Guattari quote (434).

Breiman, Leo
In "Statistical Modeling: The Two Cultures" (2001), the statistician Leo Breiman contrasts models of how data are generated with algorithms that predict without such a model.

Carney, Judith, and Richard Rosomoff
In *In the Shadow of Slavery* (2009), the geographers Judith Carney and Richard Rosomoff reproduce a 1769 militia map of a runaway community in Minas Gerais, Brazil, marking its smithies and gardens beside hidden defenses and "holes for escape" (85).

Casimir, Jean
The Haitian historian Jean Casimir shows in *The Haitians* (2020) how cultivators after the revolution built a "counter-plantation" of family farms and, "without moving from the plantations," stopped being the plantation's workers (142), a book Protevi also cites (RoV 104).

Desargues, Monge, Poncelet, Carnot, Vauban, Perronet
Engineers and mathematicians whom Deleuze and Guattari place on the borderline, from Vauban's fortifications and Desargues's perspective to Perronet's bridges (363-65).

Frangipane, Marcella
Marcella Frangipane, an archaeologist, describes the clay sealings of the "burnt village" at Sabi Abyad in northern Syria, some eight thousand years old, as records of stores shared "probably along egalitarian lines" (2018).

Garfinkle, Steven, and Seth Richardson
For Middle Bronze Age Mesopotamia (about 2000-1600 BCE), the historians Steven Garfinkle and Seth Richardson find State and community violence "rare in fact," with sanction running instead through reputation and exclusion (161).

Green, Adam
In "Killing the Priest-King" (2021), the archaeologist Adam Green describes Indus cities (about 2600-1900 BCE) with writing, standard weights, seals, and metalwork, yet no palaces or royal tombs.

Hudson, Michael
Michael Hudson, an economic historian, reconstructs the royal cancellations of agrarian debt in the ancient Near East, the "clean slates" (2002).

Humphrey, Caroline, and David Sneath
Writing on Mongolia and Inner Asia in *The End of Nomadism?* (1999), the anthropologists Caroline Humphrey and David Sneath call nomadism "a category imagined by outsiders" and prefer "mobile pastoralism" (1).

Husserl, Edmund
Nomad science takes its anexact rigor from Edmund Husserl's "vague essences," roundness as opposed to the circle (367).

Indus, Sumer, Uruk
The Indus civilization flourished in present-day Pakistan and northwest India (about 2600-1900 BCE). Sumer names the city-states of southern Mesopotamia (from about 2900 BCE), while the period of Uruk, a Mesopotamian city (about 4000-3100 BCE), gives the earliest writing, kept as accounts.

Ingold, Tim
For the anthropologist Tim Ingold, setting food aside is not yet a stock, since a stock is rights converging "upon a single interest" (1983, 553).

Lévi-Strauss, Claude
Claude Lévi-Strauss showed that the same village can present itself as segmentary and egalitarian or as encompassing and hierarchized, two potentials that Deleuze and Guattari treat as anticipations of town and State (433).

Liebenberg, Louis, and the Shadow Wolves
In *The Art of Tracking: The Origin of Science* (1990), Louis Liebenberg studies Kalahari trackers. Today, the Shadow Wolves are a unit of Native American trackers working for United States immigration enforcement on the Tohono O'odham Nation in Arizona.

Lindner, Rudi Paul
In "What Was a Nomadic Tribe?" (1982), the historian Rudi Paul Lindner shows that a nomadic tribe was made by recruitment and defection, not by descent (690, 697).

Moreno García, Juan Carlos, and Seth Richardson
In *Monarchies and the Organization of Power* (2025), the historians Juan Carlos Moreno García and Seth Richardson find Egyptian and Babylonian kings co-opting local powers they could not erase (6), with fields measured by many kinds of officer (16).

Munkh-Erdene, Lhamsuren
In *The Nomadic Leviathan* (2023), the Mongolian historian Lhamsuren Munkh-Erdene argues "for the nomadic origin of the state" in the warband of a charismatic warlord (1, 25).

Price, Richard
In *First-Time* (1983), the anthropologist Richard Price records how the Saramaka of Suriname keep the history of their ancestors' war against the planters restricted, telling it only in fragments.

Querrien, Anne
Anne Querrien, the CERFI sociologist whose work on State engineering gives Deleuze and Guattari the Gothic cathedrals and the bridges of the Ponts et Chaussées (364-66).

Serres, Michel
In *The Birth of Physics* (1977), the philosopher Michel Serres finds a hydraulic physics in Lucretius, and with it the two sciences, "a general theory of routes and paths, and a global theory of waves" (361, 372).

Simondon, Gilbert
Following matter, as opposed to imposing form, draws on the philosopher Gilbert Simondon's critique of the form-matter, or hylomorphic, model (408).

Will, Édouard
Édouard Will, a historian of archaic Greece, whose account of Corinth makes money derive from taxation (442).

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The State's three forms

Deleuze and Guattari distinguish "three major forms" of the State (459). In fact, they are not stages, since each form is in "resonance" with the others, and all of them "exhibit a unity of composition in spite of their differences in organization and development" (459). The sheet opens the single column that *The five machinic processes* gives to capture. Brackets join the forms where Deleuze and Guattari set out a relation between them.

Question	The archaic empire MARX'S "ASIATIC FORMATION"	Evolved States EMPIRES, CITIES, FEUDAL SYSTEMS, MONARCHIES	Nation-States MODELS OF REALIZATION OF THE AXIOMATIC
Where is it found?	Egypt, Mesopotamia, the Indus valley, China, and "not only in Asia, but also in Africa, America, Greece, Rome" 427, 450	Rome's empire (with its consilium and fiscus), the Aegean cities, feudal systems, and absolute monarchy 451-52, 459	Modern nation-States of every kind (democratic, totalitarian, liberal, tyrannical), as well as the bureaucratic socialist States 455-56, 459
What does it do with flows?	It **overcodes** flows already coded by the communities it rules 427-28, 459	It organizes "qualified or topical conjunctions of decoded flows" 451, 459	It realizes "a general conjugation of flows," the capitalist axiomatic 454-55, 459
What is its regime of signs?	Overcoding, "or the Signifier" 428	Processes of **subjectification** 451	The **axiomatic**, which deals "directly with purely functional elements and relations" 454
What binds a collective?	The nexum, "the objective, imperial collective bond" 428, 460	Personal bonds, from contracts between owners to the conventions that tie the owned to their owners 451	"The Subject that binds itself," a contract "between self and self" 460
	One moment of the State through all its forms: "capture, bond, knot, nexum, magical capture" 460		
What becomes of property?	Everything is public, with the despot as "the sole and transcendent public-property owner" and land that cannot be sold 428	The public sphere becomes "the shared means for a now private appropriation" 451	Property is in "convertible abstract rights," and capital is itself "a right" 453-54
What is the form of its law?	"The overcoding of customs" 453	"A set of topics," subjective and conjunctive (Roman law, cf. Veyne) 451, 453	The form of an axiomatic, as in the French civil code (cf. Ray) 453
How are persons captured?	Machinic **enslavement**, "generalized slavery" in the megamachine (cf. Mumford) 428, 457	**Subjection**: ancient slavery and feudal serfdom were already "procedures of subjection" 457	Social subjection of the "naked" or "free" worker, joined by a new enslavement in cybernetic "humans-machines systems" 457-58
	"A small amount of subjectification took us away from machinic enslavement, but a large amount brings us back to it" 458		
What kind of surplus value?	Surplus value "of code" 451	Surplus value "of flow," first among the Aegean merchants and smiths 450-51	Surplus value that "becomes machinic" with automation 458
What does it do with the war machine?	It has none of its own, working instead through police and prisons while encasting warriors captured from outside 418, 425	Appropriation proper, as in the hoplite reform's army of citizen-soldiers 419, 426	Total war, then a worldwide war machine "of which they are no longer anything more than the opposable or apposed parts" 421, 466-67
How diverse is it?	"Little diversity, due to a certain formal immutability" 459	"Extremely diverse" 459	A diversity that is "a function of isomorphy," and of heteromorphy or polymorphy 459, 464-66
What escapes it?	Decoded flows of labor and money, and private property "slipping through the net," carried by "the collective figure of the Outsider" (freed slaves, cf. Tökei) 449	Decoded flows that "draw capitalism in negative outline" but are not let "stream together" 452	Minorities as nondenumerable sets, and "undecidable propositions" 470-73
	The Aegean "presuppose[s]" the oriental stock, and "there is always an empire on the horizon" 459-60		
		"Capitalism was continually being born, disappearing and reviving at every crossroads of history" 460	
How do the forms meet?	"Capitalism has reawakened the Urstaat, and given it new strength." The modern States "restore the most absolute of empires, a new 'megamachine,' whatever the novelty or timeliness of its now immanent form" 460		

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The axiomatic today: seven points

In the present, as D&G see it, "capitalism and present-day politics are an axiomatic in the literal sense," which is why "nothing is played out in advance" (461). They set out "a summary sketch of the 'givens'" in seven parts. The last column records what, by their own account, each one leaves open to struggle.

Given	ATP	What Deleuze and Guattari say	What it leaves open to struggle
1. Addition, subtraction	461-63	Axioms are "operative statements." Social democracy adds them (Keynes and the New Deal as "axiom laboratories"), totalitarianism subtracts them, as in "the minimum State of anarcho-capitalism (cf. Chile)"	"It would be an error to take a disinterested stance toward struggle on the level of the axioms" 463
2. Saturation	463-64	Capitalism "has no laws but immanent ones." It confronts its own limits and displaces them at once (oil, nuclear power)	Local struggles must "directly target national and international axioms, at the precise point of their insertion" 464
3. Models, isomorphy	464-66	All States are models of realization: isomorphic at the center, heteromorphic in the socialist East, polymorphic at the periphery	It "would be absurd" to think popular movements condemned in advance, or all States "equivalent and homogeneous" 466
4. Power	466-67	A "power of the continuum" in the military-industrial complexes, where "peace … technologically frees the unlimited material process of total war"	The same capital "continually recreate[s] unexpected possibilities for counterattack" 422
5. The included middle	468-69	The center needs a periphery, and "internal Third Worlds" rise inside the center, with labor split between intensive surplus labor and "erratic" work	Negri's "internal margin," which "tends increasingly to merge the students with the emarginati" 469
6. Minorities	469-71	Minorities (not a demographic count but a fuzzy set) are nondenumerable sets, which States answer by "translating the minorities into denumerable sets or subsets"	The demand "to formulate their problems themselves" is what the axiomatic "cannot tolerate" 471
7. Undecidable propositions	471-73	Not "the uncertainty of the results" but "the coexistence and inseparability" of what the system conjugates and what escapes it	"The germ and locus par excellence of revolutionary decisions" 473

Poles of the capitalist State			
	Social democracy Adds axioms by organizing a domestic market and multiplying "directing axioms" 462	**Totalitarianism** Subtracts axioms and promotes the foreign sector, "the minimum State," with the population "a consequence" 462	**Fascism** A war economy and "a multiplication by subtraction," a "suicidal" State more than a totalitarian one (cf. Virilio) 462-63, 467

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Nomadology concepts: where they came from and how they were taken up

A concept, as Deleuze often put it, is the movement behind its name. Indeed, many of these names have changed meaning more than once. Each row gives a concept of the two plateaus in plain words, the field from which it came, where it was worked out before 1980 (CERFI's journal *Recherches* in 1972-73, Deleuze's seminars at Vincennes in 1979-80), and how it has been taken up since. R13 is *Recherches* 13 (December 1973), cited by its printed pages.

Concept	In plain words	Where it came from	Where it was worked out	How it has been taken up since
The five machinic processes 435, 437	Five coexisting processes (warding off, the war machine, capture, polarization, encompassment) that define social formations in place of modes of production	Two libraries: historians and urbanists (Braudel, Childe, Wittfogel, Mumford, Amin, Jacobs) for town, State, and ecumenical, and anthropologists (Clastres, Lévi-Strauss, Dumézil) for warding off, capture, and war machine	Guattari in 1973 on a Neolithic organization that survives "in Oriental despotism ... even in capitalism" R13 129. Deleuze in 1979: projecting one form onto another without precaution is "a catastrophe" seminar, 20 Nov 1979	*Taken for a typology of societies, or flattened into capture against escape, which drops the town and the ecumenical (Protevi's table has neither, RoV xx-xxi)*
Warding off (anticipation-prevention) 357-59, 429-33, 437-40	The ways in which a society anticipates a power it has never seen, so as to prevent it	Clastres's chief without command (*Society against the State*), Lévi-Strauss's two village plans (*Structural Anthropology* 149-51), and Mauss on the destruction of wealth	Deleuze names Mauss as the source that Clastres "took up and renewed" seminar, 20 Nov 1979. Guattari on the potlatch: "above all no reciprocity, even when there is reciprocity" R13 142	*An evolved disposition (Boehm's reverse dominance hierarchy, RoV 98), a damping mechanism (Protevi's "thick threshold"), or a costless equality*
Limit and threshold 437-41	The limit is the next-to-last, marking a fresh start for an assemblage. The threshold is the last, marking a change of assemblage	Jevons's "final degree of utility" (1871) and the marginalists Pirou and Pareto 566-67 nn. 24-26	Deleuze: "The marginal object is the penultimate or the limit" seminar, 27 Nov 1979	*Lost. Bonta and Protevi's glossary keeps the distinction but not its marginalist content*
Apparatus of capture 424-27, 444, 459-60	Direct comparison and monopolistic appropriation together, as in rent, profit, and tax	Dumézil's two-headed sovereignty (Varuna the binder, Mitra the jurist) in *Mitra-Varuna* (1948), together with the Roman debt bond called the nexum	Deleuze: "magic" was "a convenient and temporary word ... there is a war capture, but it is not at all the same as a State capture" seminar, 22 Jan 1980. Fourquet in 1972: "the first form of writing is accounting" R13 28	*Co-optation ("the system captures resistance"), or simply everything a State does*
Urstaat 359, 427, 460	The State presupposed by every account of its origin, which "comes into the world fully formed"	Marx's Asiatic mode (*Grundrisse*), Wittfogel, Childe, and Nietzsche's founders who come "like lightning" (*Genealogy* II.17)	Against it, in 1973: "we will have learned nothing from knowing that this State was already in germ in Sumer or in Egypt" R13 116	*Taken for a historical despotism, or for an origin*
Polarization (the town) 432-35	The town as a point on circuits of roads, a power "of the middle" that coordinates by force	Fourquet and Murard's 1976 *Les équipements du pouvoir* ("The Facilities of Power"), along with Braudel's "two runners, the state and the town" and Lévi-Strauss's village plans	Towns "always emerge as a network" before any territorial State, as with the Hanse R13 70-71, 89-92. Deleuze: "a bureaucracy of networks" seminar, 20 Nov 1979	*Almost absent from the reception, and near zero in Protevi*
Encompassment (the ecumenical) 435-36, 454	Organizations that pass through heterogeneous formations at once (trade, religions, art)	Samir Amin's *Unequal Development* (146, 295), Braudel's world-economy, and Lacarrière on the desert fathers	Islam as "an immense network," whose first public facilities were "language, money ... and religion" R13 77-79	*Almost absent, with world-systems theory taken up in its place*
Code, overcoding, axiomatic 427, 448-54, 461-62	Among the Tiv, it was good to trade food for brass rods and bad to do the reverse, while land could not be traded at all because the right to it came from descent. Such a ranking is a code, because it treats the rank of a thing as a fact about that thing that no trade can change. Overcoding keeps such codes in force but makes them answer to a higher authority, as when a king rules over communities that go on following their own customs. In contrast to code, axioms are what drive systems far more abstracted from social worlds, such as economic models adding or subtracting functions to optimize for a certain output. Assigning no rank to anything, they make no claim about truth or existence.	Lévi-Strauss's codes of exchange, the genetic code (Jacob and Monod), Hjelmslev, and set theory	Guattari in 1973: "public facilities are the axioms of capital ... no intrinsic coding" R13 131	*Confused with computer code, which is neither a code nor an axiom in their sense until a business or a State puts it to work, at which point it usually serves axioms.*
Adding axioms 462-63, 470	Capitalism's answer to whatever escapes it, which is to add an axiom for it	Set theory and Marxist accounts of co-optation	Guattari in 1973: capital is "obliged to enlarge its own axiomatic without stopping" and "the first axiom of capital is recuperation" R13 133, 140	*Folded into capture as co-optation, with recuperation as fate, though ATP calls recuperation a "disenchanted concept" (463)*
The stock 440-44	What begins when exchange stops being of interest, with land, tools, and money as stockpiled territory, activity, and exchange	Ingold on social storage (1983), Testart (1982), and Jacobs and Mellaart on Çatal Hüyük	The State as "a social machine ... for putting flows in reserve" R13 72	*Storage as a threshold toward the State (Sterelny, in RoV 98)*
Nomad and nomos 380-85, 422	The nomad inhabits a space without dividing it. The nomos is a distribution "without division into shares"	Toynbee's nomads who "stood their ground," Laroche on the root *nem-* 557 n. 51 against Schmitt's nomos as land seizure, and Ibn Khaldun	Deleuze: there are "nomades sur place" ("nomads on the spot") seminar, 25 Mar 1980	*A people of the steppe, mobility, flight, the digital nomad, Braidotti's nomadic subject*

Nomadology concepts, continued

Concepts 13-24, from nomad and nomos to the right of use.

Concept	In plain words	Where it came from	Where it was worked out	How it has been taken up since
Holey space 413-15	Space bored through mountain and subsoil by the smith, communicating with both smooth and striated space	Élie Faure on the rock-cut temples of India, Eisenstein's *Strike*, and Childe and Griaule on smiths	The vacant lot, or terrain vague ("waste ground"), as a modern holey remainder R13 173-74	*Ignored, Protevi included*
Line of flight (the leak) 204, 216, 229	From the French fuite, which is also a leak: to put a system to flight is to make it leak	French fuite ("leak," "flight") and painting's point de fuite ("vanishing point"), Anglo-American literature, George Jackson	"To put a system to flight as one bursts a tube" *Dialogues* 36. In 1973: "it leaks on all sides" R13 118-19	*Flight as leaving, exodus, or refuge (Protevi's "autonomy-seeking flight / refuge")*
War machine 351-423	A process whose positive object is to compose a smooth space and its people, with war only as its supplement	Dumézil on the warrior's exteriority, Clausewitz, Ibn Khaldun, Clastres, de Heusch, Brossollet, Virilio, Kleist	Guattari in 1972: "The ideal of despotism is Genghis Khan: destroy everything (except the artisans)" R13 29, and in 1973 "nomadic State power" R13 135	*Militarism, "the nomads" (Sneath, Munkh-Erdene), creativity in general, or any subversive collective*
Numbering number 387-94	A number that distributes people in space and moves with them, articulated and doubled by a special body	Kristeva's *Semeiotike* (293-97), Aristotle's counting number (*Physics* IV.11), the muster of Numbers 1, and Jethro's judges in Exodus 18	Deleuze on Boulez: "cipher, numbering number, nomad or Mallarmean number"	*Little used, and taken by the specialists for sovereignty*
Esprit de corps 366	A solidarity that makes the family "a band vector instead of a fundamental cell"	Ibn Khaldun's asabiyya (*The Muqaddimah*)	·	*Team spirit (Protevi's chapter on team sports, RoV 73-88)*
The secret, the cipher 390, 286-90	The cipher "invents the secret and its outgrowths," against the public knowledge of the State	Simmel on secret societies, de Heusch's man of war, and for today the anthropology of restricted knowledge (Price, Bilby, Peterson, Myers)	Deleuze in 1972: codes work by "zones of secrecy," an axiomatic by "objective concealment" seminar, 7 Mar 1972	*Knowledge treated as one more stock for capture*
Nomad and royal science 361-74, 461	Two conceptions of science in one field, the one following a material and the other reproducing a form	Serres on Lucretius, Husserl's vague essences (*Ideas* I §74), Bachelard, Simondon, Vergez on the compagnonnages, Lautman	Querrien's *Devenir fonctionnaire* (1977). Guattari in 1973: "Bourbaki is a capitalist theorist" R13 145	*Unused by Protevi, and otherwise taken as complexity theory (Bonta and Protevi) or as Indigenous or alternative knowledge*
Minority, the nondenumerable 469-71	A set defined by the relations internal to its number, which no axiom can count	Cantor's set theory and Yann Moulier-Boutang	Guattari in 1973: "a special axiom ... for the Katangans, as long as it does not leak anywhere" R13 138	*Minor as small or marginal*
Machinic enslavement and social subjection 456-60	People as parts of a machine, against people as subjects who use a machine	Mumford's megamachine, Reuleaux, Marx on constant and variable capital, and cybernetics	The city as "the social cybernetic machine of industrial capitalism" (1971) R13 20 n. 1	*Taken up for digital capitalism (Lazzarato), rarely for slavery*
Machinic phylum 404-15	Matter in movement and variation, carrying singularities and traits of expression, which can only be followed	Simondon, Childe on metallurgy, and Hjelmslev	Guattari in 1973: the phylum as "the most deterritorialized point" R13 131	·
Public facilities behind 454, 461-62	Schools, hospitals, roads, and other such facilities, which Guattari called "the axioms of capital" (not an ATP term)	French postwar planning, where équipements collectifs ("public facilities") enters the Fourth Plan in 1962	Facilities as "instruments of domination and territorial fixing of flows" R13 127	*Translated "collective equipment," and confused with infrastructure*
Channeled nomadism, the right of use not in ATP, cf. 386	The highway channels nomadism, while public service implies a general nomadism, so that "the right of use is the community"	French public service law, with its usager ("user") and droit d'usage ("right of use")	Deleuze in the CERFI discussion of public facilities R13 186	*Unknown to the reception*

ATP page numbers refer to the Minnesota translation of *A Thousand Plateaus* (1987), RoV to Protevi's *Regimes of Violence* (2025). Seminar dates refer to the Purdue transcripts of Deleuze's lectures. Translations from the French are the project's own. Source: *kit/concept_ledger.tsv*.

After 1980: what later research says about nomadology

When Deleuze and Guattari wrote the plateaus, they worked from the anthropology and archaeology of the 1970s. Those fields have changed a great deal in the decades since. Some of their findings bear out nomadology's claims. Others complicate them, and on a few points they dispute the plateaus outright. What pattern emerges? On the whole, the plateaus are most convincing when we take them as a theory of operations (the forming of a stock or the grading of a flight). Yet they are at their weakest when they make claims about origins or about which came first, which is why each row ends on a question for a new nomadology.

Claim	The record bears it out	The record complicates it	The record disputes it	What it asks of a new nomadology
The nomad holds a space and "does not move" 380-81, 410	Maroons who "settled right where they were" (Diouf 4-5), and Haitian cultivators who "ceased being cultivators" without leaving the plantation (Casimir 142)	Ancient DNA and isotopes measure displacement, which is migration, not holding (Kristiansen, Furholt). Humphrey and Sneath replace "nomadism" with "mobile pastoralism" (1)	Sneath attacks the egalitarian nomad as a trope and finds aristocracies on the steppe (*The Headless State* 3-4, 198-99)	**What evidence could register inhabiting a place without settling it, as opposed to crossing it?**
Numbering numbers, which came from the nomads 387-94	The colonial grading of flight as a numbered number, used to set punishments (Thompson 53)	Qin counties were defined by "a notional five hundred hearths" in the century of the first steppe decimal system (Sneath 237 n. 30). The Lupaqa khipu counted households (Murra)	Steppe decimal units belonged to hereditary aristocracies, with "lords of ten thousand" in name only (Sneath 3-5, 23)	**Keep numbering and numbered as two operations, distributing in space or dividing it, and drop the claim that numbering came first (389)**
The war machine is exterior, and war does not produce the State 351, 359	Steppe states formed "in relation to sedentary states" such as China (Di Cosmo 171). Lindner treats lineage as recruitment and defection (690, 697)	Kradin's Xiongnu captured outward by raiding and extortion while staying segmentary inside (77, 86)	Munkh-Erdene argues "for the nomadic origin of the state" in a warlord's warband (*The Nomadic Leviathan* 1, 25)	**Can command exist without the State-form? (357, 393)**
Societies ward off the State they anticipate, and any change past their limit 357-59, 431-33	Equality "asserted" through the ability to leave and weapons held by all (Woodburn 431, 436). Sharing as a test of relations (Peterson). Leach's Kachin oscillate instead of climbing	Resisting extraction pushed Tongan communities to stress women's reproductive roles (Gailey xi). Ritual knowledge founds rank as "looking after" (Myers 220-21). People hide food from their own kin (Peterson 864)	Boehm's "reverse dominance hierarchy" and Sterelny, both in Protevi (RoV 98), turn the operation into an evolved disposition	**Warding off takes work. Whose work is it?**
The Urstaat presupposes itself 427, 448	Early states were "more aspirational than operational" yet "presumptive of an integrated sovereign authority" (Richardson 2012, 4). Kings co-opted local powers they could not erase (Moreno García and Richardson 6)	State violence was "rare in fact" (Garfinkle and Richardson 161), which tells against the despot's terror without touching capture presupposing itself	·	**Keep presupposition as the operation, and drop the imagery of terror**
Comparison presupposes appropriation 444	Uruk scribes booked workers "just as" herds (Englund 176-77). A stock is rights converging "upon a single interest" (Ingold 553)	Sabi Abyad's many seals recorded a store shared "probably along egalitarian lines" (Frangipane 2018, 83). Indus standard weights turn up where wealth differs little (Green 159)	For Protevi, comparison and appropriation are "analytically separable" (RoV 176 n. 3)	**Is comparison a measure owned by one party and applied to others? Can a town compare without appropriating?**
The stock follows capture 428-29, 440	The order of storage and settled life is "chicken-and-egg" (Testart 524), and inequality "cannot be deduced" from storage (Ingold 553). Storage is one of four responses to risk (Halstead and O'Shea)	Mayshar and colleagues put appropriability before surplus (2022, 1092), though they locate it in the crop and not in a relation	Sterelny's storage threshold (RoV 98)	**When something is stored, is it a reserve kept in common, or a stock drawn toward a single interest?**

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After 1980, continued

Claims 8-15, from the town to the archive.

Claim	The record bears it out	The record complicates it	The record disputes it	What it asks of a new nomadology
Town and State are two thresholds 432-34	Indus cities had writing, weights, seals, and metallurgy without palaces (Green 154). Cities served as refuges, with nomadism produced by urban flight (Yoffee 60)	Arslantepe had central institutions without a city (Frangipane 2012). Teotihuacan was founded by displaced people and governed corporately (Manzanilla). Fletcher's settlements have "an almost indefinable edge" (xxiii)	·	**What common measure belongs to the town, as distinct from the State's comparison?**
Capitalism wins through the State-form, not the town-form, and makes the ecumenical its own 434-37, 454	Steppe pastoralists were "key players" among "core" civilizations while staying "strategically independent and small-scale" (Frachetti 2). For Amin, no "pure theory of international relations" is possible (*Unequal Development* 131-32)	A world-economy "always has an urban centre of gravity, a city," from Venice and Antwerp to Amsterdam (Braudel, *The Perspective of the World* 27). In medieval Italy, Flanders and Germany, "the town won entirely" for a time (Braudel, *Capitalism and Material Life* 397)	·	**Which processes compose capitalism in a given time and place, and which still work against it?**
Four regimes of violence: struggle, war, crime, policing 447-48	"State terror" came before its use by the State's enemies (Richardson 2016)	Sanction by reputation and exclusion did most of the work in Middle Bronze Age Mesopotamia (Garfinkle and Richardson 161). Old Babylonian law treated flight as theft by whoever helped (Richardson 2023, 19-20)	·	**Is sanction without violence policing, or a fifth regime?**
Royal science captures nomad science 362-68	Rice knowledge was captured along with its bearers, with the task measured by the ditch (Carney 99). Caste and royal investiture separated the forge from kingship (Herbert 26, 138). Even the trials that farmers ran on their own fields were taxed, so as to fund the science that would replace them (Richards 160)	Maroon Science, learned through "testing and evasion," is a science whose object is capture itself (Bilby 4). Tracking reasons by hypothesis and deduction, the epistemology ATP gives royal science (Liebenberg 3)	·	**Extend nomad science to sciences of evasion, and add the routes of capture ATP lacks: caste, the unit of work, the tax**
The secret and the cipher 390	Saramaka history is kept restricted and "told in fragments," with experts "on a single hand" (Price, *First-Time* 7-8, 21)	Ritual knowledge escapes demand sharing (Peterson 868) and founds hierarchy without a State (Myers 220-21). Kromanti ceremonies are performed for tourists (Bilby 14)	·	**Restricted knowledge both founds hierarchy and shields those who keep it against capture. Who holds the measure of access?**
Smooth space will not save us (Protevi's marronage) 387, 500; RoV 96-120	The campo negro ("black countryside"), a formation "inside slavery and an alternative to it" (Gomes 282). Three processes in one swamp (Sayers 105-08)	The treaty of 1739 turned Jamaica's Maroons into an instrument of capture (Campbell 130). Grades of flight were a planters' metric (Thompson 53)	Roberts's *Freedom as Marronage* (2015) enlarges flight into a general model	**The colonial word marronage merges the nomad who stays in place with the migrant who flees. Split it**
The empires vanish when a war machine "bears down from without" 459	Teotihuacan's center was destroyed by "a premeditated, highly selective" action against the seats of power (López Luján et al. 13)	"What it is that is supposed to be collapsing" (Cowgill). At Arslantepe, new chiefs ruled by "managing the conflicts" (Frangipane 2012, 239). States regenerate by emulation (Schwartz 7)	Tainter's return to "lower complexity" is evolutionism run backward	**How can the end of a capture be named from somewhere other than the State?**
History is one with the triumph of States 393-94	The tribe as the settled archive's prey (Lindner). The 1769 map of a quilombo was drawn by the expedition sent to destroy it (Carney and Rosomoff 85). Trouillot's silences in the making of the archive	Regional survey records "distributions of artifacts in space," not only sites (Dunnell and Dancey 267). A Gini coefficient over house sizes is itself a numbered number (Kohler et al.)	·	**Work from distributions, not absences. An absence of material is not evidence of refusal**

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Research since 1980, by area

After stage theory fell out of favor, no whole school in these fields has worked the way nomadology does. Rather, several smaller areas of research have done so in part, and it is these that we place here. For each area, the table gives what it studies (which of the five processes it examines, capture for instance) along with its way of working, as some areas follow their material while others impose a model on it. Its relation to nomadology then appears on a single scale, from nearest to farthest, with each judgment made about a work rather than about its author.

● convergent: works the way nomadology does ○ complementary: a sound account of one process, such as capture ○ source of evidence, with the frame set aside ◌ nominal affinity: shares the vocabulary, not the method ● antithetical

Area of research	Representative works	What it studies	How it works	Relation to nomadology	What to take from it	What it leaves out
Maroon history and archaeology after 1979	Gomes, Diouf, Sayers, Weik, Casimir, Bilby, Price's *First-Time*, Carney and Rosomoff	Marronage, with capture around it	Social history, historical archaeology, ethnography under restriction	● Convergent	A positive account of the outside, in which holding in place counts as much as departure	*Rarely compared with other formations*
Hunter-gatherer ethnography of sharing and storage	Woodburn, Peterson, Myers, Ingold 1983, Testart's reply	Warding off, described in operation	Ethnography	○ Complementary on warding off	Equality asserted, the stock as a relation, knowledge as the stock that warding off does not level	·
Indigenous and captured sciences	Richards, Carney, Herbert, Gladwin, Detienne and Vernant	Nomad science and its capture	Field research, history	● Convergent, in part	Capture by caste, by the unit of work, by the tax, and knowledge that exists only in operation	·
Mesopotamian economic history	Richardson, Garfinkle and Richardson, Steinkeller, Hudson and Van De Mieroop, Englund, Moreno García	Capture, set against the record's view of itself	Philology, economic history	○ Complementary on capture	The presumptive State, the uncounted, people booked like herds, violence mostly represented	*Little about life outside the archive*
Egalitarian urbanism and recording	Green on the Indus, Frangipane on Sabi Abyad and Arslantepe, Manzanilla on Teotihuacan, Yoffee, Fletcher	The town, and capture without a city	Site archaeology, synthesis	○ Complementary on the town	Towns and recording without the State, collapse as redistribution	*The town's own measures, not yet theorized*
The planters' metric	Thompson, Campbell	Capture through and inside marronage	History	○ Complementary on capture	Grades of flight as a numbered number, the treaty as capture by pact	·
Steppe revisionism	Sneath, Munkh-Erdene, Humphrey and Sneath, Lindner, Frachetti	Mostly capture (aristocratic order, nomadic statehood), Lindner the war machine	History, historical anthropology	○ Source of evidence	The decimal institution, with muster set against assessment. The disagreement about concepts is real	*Defines nomadism by movement, which ATP refuses*
Stage evolutionism, neo-evolutionism, cliodynamics	Service, Fried, Flannery 1972, Turchin's Seshat, Tainter	Capture	Coded variables, types, sequences	● Antithetical	Data only	*Stages, seen from the State*
Comparative early state, heterarchy, dual processes	Claessen and Skalník, Khazanov, Blanton, Crumley	Capture	Types, interpretive comparison	◌ Nominal affinity	·	*Stages and typologies return, and no exteriority*
Anarchist archaeology and the voluntarist synthesis	Angelbeck and Grier, Borck and Sanger, Graeber and Wengrow	Warding off	Voluntarist	◌ Nominal affinity	·	*Prevention without anticipation, choice in place of process*
The ontological turn and multispecies work	Viveiros de Castro, Descola, Kohn, Tsing	Thought of the outside, without process	Comparison of ontologies, patchiness	◌ Nominal affinity	·	*Capture disappears, and comparison is given up*
Assemblage archaeology	Harris, Fowler, Hamilakis and Jones, Olsen, Witmore	None: a flat ontology	Deleuzian vocabulary by way of DeLanda	◌ Nominal affinity	·	*No State-form, no nomad science*
Mobility science	Ancient DNA and isotopes (Kristiansen), Demoule's critique	Movement as population replacement	Genetics, isotopes	◌ Nominal affinity	Demoule, by contrast, is convergent: the steppe invasion as an artifact of the family tree	*Measures migration, not nomadism*

Placements from the project's source assessment (*work/assessment/source_assessment_v2.md*), which Jo may revise.

Neighboring fields

Nomadology is not confined to the fields it engages most often, which here are anthropology and archaeology, with history beside them. In their notes, Deleuze and Guattari also draw on mathematics, military theory, political economy and the history of science (Archimedes, Clausewitz, Marx, Husserl), and so must a new nomadology. Listed below are the neighboring fields that our reading has touched so far, each with what it offers a new nomadology.

Field	Works	What it offers nomadology
History of science and craft	Pamela Smith, *The Body of the Artisan* (2004). Detienne and Vernant, *Cunning Intelligence* (1974). Richards, *Indigenous Agricultural Revolution* (1985)	Craft knowledge outside the State's division of labor, and mētis ("cunning intelligence"), a knowledge that exists only in operation. Candidates for minor science
Navigation and tracking	Gladwin, *East Is a Big Bird* (1970). Liebenberg, *The Art of Tracking* (1990). The Shadow Wolves	The Puluwat navigator's vessel holds a place while the world passes (Gladwin 181-83), a local absolute. Once a border agency enlists them, trackers put following in the State's service
Prediction and platform labor	Breiman, "Statistical Modeling: The Two Cultures" (2001). Gray and Suri, *Ghost Work* (2019). Agre, "Surveillance and Capture" (1994). Galison on Wiener (1994)	The axiomatic predicting without a model of the process, a "last mile" of human tasks that shifts as each one is automated (Gray and Suri xxii), and capture as the reorganization of activity for tracking
Military theory	Brossollet, *Essai sur la non-bataille* ("Essay on the Nonbattle," 1975). Noyer, "De la notion de guérilla à la notion de techno-guérilla" ("From Guerrilla to Techno-Guerrilla," 1990). Lawrence	Brossollet is D&G's own source for the nonbattle and the "unspecified enemy." Noyer shows a State army taking up guerrilla technique. Theorists of the Israeli army have used ATP too (Weizman), which shows how widely its vocabulary has been taken up
Political economy of the ancient world	Hudson and Van De Mieroop, *Debt and Economic Renewal* (2002). Meillassoux, *The Anthropology of Slavery* (1986). Kohler et al. (2017)	Clean slates that keep dependents dependent on the palace, the sale that confirms a depersonalization already inflicted (capture presupposing itself), and wealth disparities measured as a numbered number
Political theory of the State and its outside	Scott, *The Art of Not Being Governed* (2009). Simpson and Coulthard on Indigenous refusal. Moten and Harney	Scott's legibility is a sound account of comparison, though his hill peoples are known only through flight. Refusal against settler capture is a sound account of warding off. Fugitivity as ontology flattens geography and capture
Archive and history	Trouillot, *Silencing the Past* (1995). Stoler. Fuentes. Lindner, "What Was a Nomadic Tribe?" (1982)	The archive as made by capture, with a history of what it silenced. Trouillot's new State that killed the leader and took his name for its palace
Scholarship on nomadology itself	See the next page	The field in which a new nomadology works, set out by strand
The crossover canon	Braidotti's nomadic subject, Tsing, Scott, Graeber and Wengrow	Where adopters of nomadology usually turn instead of doing the disciplinary research the plateaus did. The project keeps these out of its argument by rule, citing them only as cautionary examples

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Scholarship on nomadology

Nomadology has a scholarship of its own, which runs from the first guides to the plateaus to recent work that takes them back into their partner fields. Such strands are a beginning and not a census. Jo will add to them. Except for Protevi and Culp, titles and dates are listed from memory and still need to be checked against copies.

Strand	Work	How it uses nomadology
Guides and systematic readings	Massumi, *A User's Guide to Capitalism and Schizophrenia* (1992)	A guide to both volumes by the translator of *A Thousand Plateaus*
	Holland, *Deleuze and Guattari's A Thousand Plateaus: A Reader's Guide* (2013)	A plateau-by-plateau guide
	Bonta and Protevi, *Deleuze and Geophilosophy* (2004)	A guide and glossary that takes smooth space toward complexity theory
	Lampert, *Deleuze and Guattari's Philosophy of History* (2006)	Coexistence and simultaneity against succession
The State, capitalism, and Marx	Sibertin-Blanc, *State and Politics: Deleuze and Guattari on Marx* (2016)	The two plateaus as a theory of the State and of violence, with a limit for each process
	Thoburn, *Deleuze, Marx and Politics* (2003)	Minor politics and the refusal of work
	Holland, *Nomad Citizenship* (2011)	Markets without capitalism, and a citizenship of the nomadic
	Lazzarato, *Signs and Machines* (2014)	Machinic enslavement and social subjection in today's capitalism
	Hardt and Negri, *Empire* (2000)	Desertion and exodus of a nomadic multitude, closer to the migrant than the nomad
War, technology, and the military	DeLanda, *War in the Age of Intelligent Machines* (1991)	Military history along the machinic phylum
	Alliez and Lazzarato, *Wars and Capital* (2016)	The war machine and capital, with wars waged against populations
	Weizman, "Lethal Theory" (2006), *Hollow Land* (2007)	How theorists in the Israeli army used *A Thousand Plateaus* to move through walls
Political theory and anarchism	Patton, *Deleuze and the Political* (2000)	Capture and the war machine as concepts of political philosophy
	Nail, *Returning to Revolution* (2012), *Theory of the Border* (2016)	Nomadology and the Zapatistas, then a theory of borders and movement
	Colson, *Petit lexique philosophique de l'anarchisme* ("A Short Philosophical Lexicon of Anarchism," 2001)	Deleuze and Guattari among the anarchists
	Culp, *Dark Deleuze* (2016)	A darker Deleuze of the outside, against the joyous reading
Space and geography	Antonioli, *Géophilosophie de Deleuze et Guattari* ("Deleuze and Guattari's Geophilosophy," 2003)	Territory, the earth, and geophilosophy
	Saldanha, *Space After Deleuze* (2017)	Space and race after Deleuze
Critiques of nomadology's anthropology	Miller, "The Postidentitarian Predicament in the Footnotes of *A Thousand Plateaus*" (1993)	Traces the plateaus' nomads to the colonial anthropology in their notes, and questions the authority it lends them
	Kaplan, *Questions of Travel* (1996)	The nomad as a romantic figure of theory, at the expense of actual displacement
	Braidotti, *Nomadic Subjects* (1994)	Turns the nomad into a figure of subjectivity, the most widely adopted use of the word
Back into the partner fields	Protevi, *Political Affect* (2009), *Edges of the State* (2019), *Regimes of Violence* (2025)	The furthest return to anthropology and archaeology, adding a becoming-maroon
	Badaire	Deleuze and Guattari's critical uses of the social sciences (title to add)

Titles from memory, to be checked against copies (Protevi and Culp excepted).

Nomadology bibliography

Deleuze and Guattari built nomadology out of other people's research: myth, anthropology, archaeology, history, mathematics, military theory, and political economy, with literature throughout. Their notes to the two plateaus (ATP 552-71) cite about a hundred works, grouped here by field, each with what it contributed to the plateaus. Sources marked AGAINST are ones they dispute or correct, which is part of the method too. Yet every field here has changed in the fifty years since.

Myth, religion, and ancient thought 8

Dumézil, *Mitra-Varuna* (1948), *The Destiny of the Warrior*, *Mythe et épopée* The two heads of sovereignty (the binder and the jurist), the warrior's three sins, the nexum 351-55, 424-26

de Heusch, *Le roi ivre* (1972) The Bantu myth of Nkongolo and Mbidi, with the secret of the man of war 353

Detienne, *Les maîtres de vérité* (1973), and on the phalanx Two poles of Greek thought, the warriors between them, isonomy, the hoplite reform 375, 399, 426

Vernant, *Mythe et pensée chez les Grecs* The city-state's homogeneous geometrical extension 388

AGAINST **Eliade, *Images and Symbols* (1961)** The binder-god, studied by a "syncretic and archetypal" method that D&G set against Dumézil's differential one 424

Hélène Clastres, *La terre sans mal* (1975) Tupi-Guarani prophets against the chiefs 357, 384

Alphandéry, *La chrétienté et l'idée de croisade* The Crusade's changes of course as part of its idea 384

Lacarrière, *Les hommes ivres de Dieu* (1975) The desert fathers, Christianity's own bands and deserts 436

Anthropology and ethnography 12

Pierre Clastres, *Society against the State* (1977), "Archéologie de la violence" (1980) Warding off the State, war against the State, the chief without command 357-59, 429

Mauss (by way of Clastres) The potlatch as a check on the concentration of wealth 357

Lévi-Strauss, *Structural Anthropology* (149-51) One village, two plans, segmentary or hierarchized 433

Berthe, "Aînés et cadets" (1965) The "third village" that keeps the circuit from closing 433

Meunier, *Les gamins de Bogota* (1977) Street gangs that keep their leader from gaining stable power 358

Griaule and Dieterlen, *Le renard pâle* (1965) Dogon smiths, "mixed" rather than impure 415

Pottier on Tuareg smiths (1945), Bloch, *Les Tziganes* (1969) Smiths as a special body, and cave dwelling beyond nomad and sedentary 393, 413

AGAINST **Cline (1937) and Clément (1948) on African smiths** Studies of how others regard the smith, which D&G find "hardly conclusive" 413

Gluckman, *Custom and Conflict in Africa* (1959) Immutable form with constant rebellion 385

Thesiger, *Arabian Sands* (1959), Carpenter, *Eskimo* (1964), Emperaire, *Les nomades de la mer* (1954) Deserts of sand and ice as haptic, sonorous space, and the itineraries of sea nomads 382

Milovanoff on the nomad's tent (1978) A dwelling tied to an itinerary, not a territory 380

Bernstein on primate dominance (1978) Leadership that inhibits stable power 358

Archaeology and prehistory 6

Childe, *The Prehistory of European Society*, *The Most Ancient East* The itinerant smith, the agricultural surplus, the Aegean's freer artisans 412, 415, 428, 450-51

Mellaart, *Çatal Hüyük* (1967), and Jane Jacobs's "New Obsidian" A stock before agriculture, with the town creating the country 428-29, 440

Griaznov, *The Ancient Civilization of Southern Siberia* (1969) Nomadism begun by farmers who left the town 430

Leroi-Gourhan, *Milieu et techniques* (1945) Types of percussion, and a technological vitalism 395, 407

Forbes, *Metallurgy in Antiquity* (1950), Limet on Sumerian metal (1960) The miner, smelter, smith, and metalworker, and twelve varieties of copper 405, 415

Harmand, *La guerre antique* (1973) An archaic State that works through jailers before warriors 427

History 14

Braudel, *Capitalism and Material Life* (1967) "Two runners, the state and the town," East and West, the tool as result 385, 399, 434, 468

Toynbee, *A Study of History* The nomad who "does not move" 381

AGAINST **Hubac, *Les nomades* (1948)** Local climates, though he "tends to confuse nomads and migrants" 382

Ibn Khaldun, *The Muqaddimah* Esprit de corps, with the countryside as nomos 366, 380

AGAINST **Vladimirtsov, *Le régime social des Mongols* (1948)** Genghis Khan's guard of "antrustions," and a feudal account of the steppe that D&G reject 392, 394

Grousset, *The Empire of the Steppes* Tamerlane against Genghis Khan 419

Ssu-ma Ch'ien, "The Account of the Hsiung-nu" Number and direction in the war machine 390

Lynn White Jr., *Medieval Technology and Social Change* (1962) The stirrup, the heavy plow, long technological lineages 399, 404

Mazaheri, "Le sabre contre l'épée" (1958) Saber and sword as two technological lineages 404-06

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Tökei on Chinese landed property (1958) and the Asiatic mode Freed slaves as the seeds of private property 449

Veyne, *Le pain et le cirque* (1976), Boulvert (1974) Roman subjective law as "topics," freedmen in the imperial service 451

Lombard, Chaunu, Musset, Gautier, Watt, Chevalier East and West, the invasions, North Africa, Medina, Paris's "nomads" 380, 383, 385

Charrière, *Scythian Art*, Musset on runes, Pelliot on Mongol scripts Jewelry, runic writing, borrowed scripts 401-02

Mathematics, physics, and philosophy of science 15

Serres, *La naissance de la physique* (1977) The first three traits of nomad science, the clinamen, "rigorous, anexact" 361-62, 367, 372

Boulez, *Boulez on Music Today* Smooth and striated space-time 362, 477-78

Proclus, and Bouligand, *Le déclin des absolus* (1949) The theorematic against the problematic, problems against the global synthesis 362, 374

Husserl, *Ideas* I §74, *Origin of Geometry* (with Derrida) Vague essences, protogeometry 367

Bachelard, *Essai sur la connaissance approchée* (1927) The rigor of the anexact 367

Simondon, *L'individu* (1964), *Du mode d'existence* (1969) The critique of hylomorphism, from the mold to modulation and metallurgy 369, 408-10

Lautman, *Les schémas de structure* (1938) Riemann spaces immersed in a Euclidean one 373

Brunschvicg, Chasles, Desargues's *Oeuvres* The line from Desargues to Monge and Poncelet, "founders of a modern geometry" 363, 365

Kristeva, *Semeiotike* (1969) The traits of the numbering number 390

Guéroult on Leibniz (1934) Work against free action 397

AGAINST **Benveniste on rhythm (1971)** Rhythm as form, "ambiguous" to D&G for leaving out hydraulics 363

Blanché, *L'axiomatique* (1959), the intuitionists (Brouwer, Heyting) Saturation, models, undecidable propositions, a calculus of problems 455, 461

Worringer, *Form in Gothic* (1927) The Gothic line and nonorganic life 411

Querrien, *Devenir fonctionnaire* (CERFI), Vergez on the compagnonnages (1976) Gothic builders, State engineers, the cutting line 364-66

de Montmollin, *Les systèmes hommes-machines* (1967) "Humans-machines" systems 458

War and strategy 7

Clausewitz, *On War*, with Aron, *Penser la guerre* (1976) Absolute war as Idea, real wars between two poles 389, 419-21

Lawrence, *Seven Pillars of Wisdom*, "The Science of Guerrilla War" The nonbattle 416

Brossollet, *Essai sur la non-bataille* (1975) The nonbattle and the "unspecified enemy" 416, 422

AGAINST **Virilio, *Speed and Politics*, *L'insécurité du territoire*** Polis as police, the fleet in being, dromocracy, the inversion of Clausewitz, though he "tends to equate" three kinds of speed 386-87, 395-96, 421, 467

Fuller, *Armament and History* (1945) Weapons and tools identical for ages, the tank as a land ship 395, 397

Ludendorff, *Der totale Krieg* (1935), Nef, *War and Human Progress* Total war and its economy 421

Jünger, *Traité du rebelle*, *The Glass Bees* The Rebel between Worker and Soldier, and mutilation 403, 426

Political economy 13

Marx, *Grundrisse*, *Capital* The Asiatic formation, rent, the trinity formula, primitive accumulation 427, 441-47, 452

Wittfogel, *Oriental Despotism* (1957) Waterworks and empire 363, 427

Jevons, Pirou, Pareto, Fradin The marginal "last," ophelimity, groping evaluation 437-39

Ricardo, *Principles* Differential rent 441

Bernard Schmitt, *Monnaie, salaires et profits* (1980) The model of capture in four steps 442, 445-46

Samir Amin, *Unequal Development*, *Accumulation on a World Scale* No economic theory of international relations, the axioms of the periphery 436, 465, 469

Emmanuel, *Unequal Exchange*, Sweezy, Dobb Indirect tax, capital as a homogeneous fund, rights to wealth 443, 453

Mumford, "The First Megamachine" (1966), *The Pentagon of Power* The archaic empire as a machine made of people 428, 457, 460

Fourquet and Murard, *Les équipements du pouvoir* (1976), Jean Robert, Balazs, Châtelet Towns as networks, the inversion of signs, the doubtful city-state 431-33, 447

Ray on the civil code (1926) Modern law as an axiomatic 453

Faye, *Langages totalitaires* (1972) The Nazi economy 463

Tronti, Negri, and Italian autonomia, Moulier The refusal of work, the internal margin 469, 472

AGAINST **Engels, *The Origin of the Family*** Three theses on the State's origin, all of which "beg the question" 427

Literature, art, and philosophy 8

Kleist, *Penthesilea*, "On the Gradual Formation of Ideas in Speech", "On the Marionette Theater" Secrecy, speed, affect, thought as a war machine 355-56, 378, 400

Nietzsche, *Schopenhauer as Educator*, *Genealogy* II.17 The private thinker, founders who come like lightning 353, 376-77

Artaud's letters to Rivière, Rimbaud, Kenneth White Thought without image, the inferior race, intellectual nomadism 378-79

Foucault, "La pensée du dehors" (1966) The form of exteriority of thought 377

AGAINST **Kojève, Weil, and Jaspers** A Hegelianism of the right that "weds the destiny of thought to the State" 375-79

Élie Faure, *History of Art*, Eisenstein, *Strike* Holey space 413-14

Castaneda, *The Teachings of Don Juan*, Herbert, *Children of Dune* Following the devil's weed, a walk without measure 372, 390

Starobinski, *Trois fureurs* (1974), Shakespeare, Kafka Ajax, Richard III, the nomads in the capital 353-55

Pages are those of the text where a source enters, with the notes to those pages, in the Minnesota translation of *A Thousand Plateaus* (1987). Titles and dates as given in the notes.

The seminars and the CERFI

Much of the two plateaus was worked out aloud first, in the 1979-80 seminar at Vincennes on "Apparatuses of Capture and War Machines", thirteen sessions between November and March, with students (Éric Alliez, Georges Comtesse, Richard Pinhas, Claire Parnet) intervening. The table matches each session to the pages it develops; the list below names the other places the ideas were worked out. Every passage, with verified quotations, is in *work/context/context_12_13.md* and under "Elsewhere" on the web reference.

Session	Date	What it works out	ATP
1	6 Nov 1979	The year's five oppositions: space, number, work against free action, weapons and jewels against tools and signs, and affects against sentiments. Also police before army, the phylum; Engels's three theses; the three heads of capture	351-403, 424-48
2	13 Nov 1979	Civil capture; the Asiatic mode; code and overcoding; the megamachine; machinic enslavement and social subjection; Jacobs's stock before agriculture	424-29, 449-58
3	20 Nov 1979	Clastres and Mauss; anticipation-warding off; the two waves; town and State (Braudel); the ecumenical; "the last glass"	357-60, 429-39
4	27 Nov 1979	The marginal shepherd; limit and threshold; seeds against obsidian axes	435-39
5	15 Jan 1980	Personal dependency; the man of the lament (Tökei)	449-51
6	22 Jan 1980	Territory and land; comparison and appropriation; the despotic face; "magic"; Kafka's two bureaucracies; the freed slave	424, 440-51
7	29 Jan 1980	Alliez on mercantilism; overcoding's decoded flows; Childe's East and West; topical conjunctions	428-29, 443-53
8	5 Feb 1980	Capital's nominal and real definitions; land rent; the minimum State; NASA; the nation; what an axiomatic is	452-73
9	26 Feb 1980	Minor science (Euclid and Archimedes, Desargues, Monge, Poncelet); formalization and axiomatic	361-74, 454-61
10	4 Mar 1980	The police at Vincennes; the "unspecified enemy"	422, 467
11	11 Mar 1980	Adding and subtracting axioms; totalitarian, social-democratic, fascist; saturation	461-63
12	18 Mar 1980	Aim and objective; the immanent limit; Linhart's "modern hunger"; isomorphy; the periphery	420-21, 463-69
13	25 Mar 1980	Metallurgical peoples and holey space; nomads in place; power and total war; undecidables; minorities	380-82, 411-15, 420-22, 466-73

Deleuze's other seminars 4

27 Feb 1979, "Metal, Metallurgy, Music, Husserl, Simondon" Vague essences, molding against modulation, metal as continuous variation, the smith beside the musician 367-69, 404-15

1977 (A Thousand Plateaus II) Kleist against Goethe, haecceities, the two planes 355-56, 368-69

1971-72 (Anti-Oedipus I) The Asiatic State "in one blow", code and axiomatic, finite and infinite debt 427, 449-55

1981 (Painting) Worringer's Gothic line, Riegl's haptic 382, 411

With Parnet, with Guattari 4

***Dialogues* (1977), "Many Politics"** Propositions I-III in a paragraph; lines of flight turned to abolition; absolute peace 351-61, 421-23

Interview, early 1970s (*Chaosophy*) "a revolution requires a war machine, but this is not a state apparatus" 422-23

Guattari, on machinic enslavement (*Soft Subversions*) Enslavement and subjection, from Guattari's side 456-58

Guattari's seminars, 1980-88 The war machine as a position in schizoanalytic cartography (1982) 351

The CERFI 2

***Recherches* 13 (Dec 1973), "Les équipements du pouvoir"** The Plan, collective equipment, town and State, with Deleuze, Guattari, Foucault in conversation 364-68, 431-33

Querrien, *Devenir fonctionnaire* (1978) Nomad masons, cutting by templates, Trudaine's assemblies, the commoner corps 364-68

Seminar transcripts and translations: The Deleuze Seminars (Purdue), 1979-80 trans. Kerslake and Stivale. A revised edition of the 1979-80 seminar is Lapoujade, ed., *Sur l'appareil d'État et la machine de guerre* (Minuit, 2025). Pages are those of the Minnesota translation of ATP.

About

The sheets are by Andrew Culp (California Institute of the Arts) and the *A Thousand Plateaus* research group of The Public School Los Angeles (instagram.com/thepublicschoolla), a weekly reading group begun in 2024 that works through the plateau line by line. Its question:

What do we still have to learn from the Treatise on Nomadology after devastating decades of neoliberal austerity and reactionary neofascisms?

It reads with two aims in particular, a philosophical definition of the State, including state thought, and new paths for the war machine.

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All the projects. minor-science.github.io

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The French and Massumi's English, sentence by sentence. minor-science.github.io/thousand-plateaus-reader

Source files
github.com/minor-science/nomadology-reference

STILL TO COME

A short account of nomadology: a short essay on what the two plateaus argue, as a study of how the State converts what lies outside it.